

A POKÉMON FANGAME / CREATIVE RECORD

TIDEBOUND

Game bible

A solitary journey through a wounded coastal land,
where the sea keeps the dead and love can become
an excuse to refuse their absence.

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Working title / Full story spoilers

Confirmed decisions, proposals, and intentional mysteries

How to use this bible

This is the consolidated creative record for the whole game. It expands and supersedes the short design record dated 8 September 2026. It preserves established decisions, outlines a playable narrative, and identifies what still needs invention. It describes the intended game, not a claim that these chapters have already been built.

Current playable milestone: 0.7.20, Natu's dark prelude before the two false bedrooms. This revision implements the previously reserved lighthouse cellar/vault and the first dock-city museum hall. Earlier statements reserving those spaces describe the 0.6 necklace milestone and are superseded for this limited visit. The museum heist, the sabre's magical use and the final confrontation remain future content.

Confirmed means explicitly established or accepted in the worldbuilding conversation. **Proposed** means a possible implementation, interpretation, or new connective detail. **Open** means a decision has not been made. **Intentional mystery** means the finished story should withhold an answer. **Prototype** describes existing content or temporary mechanics, which do not automatically become final lore.

These labels apply to the passage or subsection they introduce. In mixed passages, individual statements carry their own label. The proposed chapter order is an editorial outline built around confirmed events. A useful proposal is not canon merely because it appears here. Explicit later decisions from the creative director take precedence.

The game bible governs fictional facts, characterisation, emotional intent, and narrative relationships. The separate developer guide, **AGENTS.md**, governs implementation and continuity. Keep both current. Do not resolve a contradiction by silently changing established lore.

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1. The emotional promise

1.1 The experience

Confirmed. The dominant feeling is dark, sad, nostalgic, and haunted: "bottomless sadness" interrupted by moments of absolute terror and significant beauty and hope. Japanese horror, including the user's association with *Ringu*, informs the presence of an ancient, majestic, frightening sea. *Dark Souls* informs solitude, wounded places, obscure histories, brief companionship, and encounters that retain emotional weight after they end.

The game remains recognisably a Pokémon adventure. The player travels with individual creatures, learns their habits, battles, catches, explores, and gradually understands a region. The familiar structure acquires a different meaning when companions can disappear and many human institutions have fallen silent.

Design interpretation. The central emotional movement is attachment followed by reinterpretation. A frightening apparition becomes a friend. A warm friend returns and becomes a horror. A familiar sanctuary becomes toxic. A supposedly fortunate gift becomes evidence of a mother's hidden ritual. The same place or relationship should mean something different after the player learns more.

1.2 Solitude and its exceptions

Confirmed. There is no conventional rival or professor. The player is fundamentally alone. Trainer battles are relatively sparse. Riddles, sad conversations, exploration, and helping people carry much of the journey. Some quests succeed; some fail despite sincere effort.

Design interpretation. Solitude needs exceptions to remain perceptible. Koga must be warm enough to miss. The mother's house must feel like a home before its mystery deepens. A resting fire should sometimes offer uncomplicated relief. Pokémon should have small recognisable behaviours outside their usefulness in battle.

Hope should produce observable changes. A repaired roof, a person eating again, a path made safe, or a companion returning can matter without repairing the entire world. Do not make every kindness a trap or every survivor secretly monstrous. Constant betrayal would weaken the special force of pseudo-Koga.

1.3 The recurring question

Design interpretation. How far can someone go to protect what they love before protection becomes possession, confinement, or destruction?

The villagers want Koga back. Pseudo-Koga protects a settlement by poisoning it. Mother alters her child's relation to death. The player tries to retrieve fallen companions. The ancient wrong concerns greed and its victims. These stories should illuminate one another without becoming mechanically identical or morally interchangeable.

The game should allow grief, loyalty, and the desire to save others to remain valuable. Their vulnerability to corruption does not make affection itself a mistake.

2. Canon at a glance

The following are confirmed foundations. Later sections distinguish their unresolved details.

- The region has an entirely new map, story, and custom regional Pokédex, including regional variants and a new evolution beyond Xatu.
- The sea herself is a majestic dark entity. Her deepest nature remains partly beyond explanation.
- The protagonist lives in a lighthouse with their elderly mother, its sole keeper.
- Mother believes in the water entities' mythology. Her ritual was not performed solely for the child's benefit and keeps the protagonist forever a child. Its full religious purpose remains open.
- The starting village's other permanent human residents are all elderly. Casual comments about the protagonist's unchanging youth foreshadow the truth.
- Mother's guilt made her exceptionally careful and overprotective. Her own advancing age now forces her to release the child from this gentle containment and prepare them for the world.
- The early account is domestic: Mother says the protagonist is old enough to explore and that she wants to teach them while she still has time. The ritual and arrested childhood are late revelations.
- The setting evokes the past: no advanced electronic technology. Books, runes and magic fit the world. A precise historical period is not fixed; steampunk remains a future possibility.
- The opening proceeds from the two false bedroom puzzles and bedroom play with Natu, through Mother's talk and Pookie's first walk, to a household companion choice. The oil and lamp errand follows. The chosen trio is Natu, Makuhita and Poochyena.
- No professor, conventional rival, or normal gym circuit structures the adventure.
- Criminals prey on deserted, impoverished communities. Dangerous wild Pokémon also genuinely torment people.
- The criminal organisation's desperate, foolish actions unleash water demons and intensify the later crisis.
- Shrines of old masters replace gyms. Most later shrines stand empty until special incense summons a master for a battle.
- Dive is required for the intended world and late exploration.
- A substantial forest occupies the region; its central placement is the leading proposal.
- Natu fills the common-bird role. A special item eventually enables a powerful regional evolution after Xatu.
- Regional Lapras is Water/Ghost: frightening apparition, beloved companion, unsettling revelation, then a late connection to a Water/Ghost legendary's magic.
- Young Koga is a lively, ambitious, warm prodigy. He discovers Poison Pokémon's usefulness against demonic enemies.
- Koga and his absent mother inspired a winter mountain dojo community. His sister is a major character and a trainer the player can battle.

- Ninja Apprentices concentrate in this part of the map and respectfully invite the player to train with them.
- Rumours associate prolonged exposure to poisonous Pokémon with corruption of the mind.
- Real Koga helps for a time, disappears, and remains missing when his storyline ends.
- Desperate villagers conjure a poison imitation of Koga. It contains no real Koga and is not his returned soul.
- The false reunion initially feels deeply comforting, including companionship in the astral plane. Cruelty and extreme corruption follow.
- Pseudo-Koga poisons the white winter settlement to defend it, producing purple contamination and green sludge.
- Before fighting him, the player confronts the poisoning of a cherished forest refuge and a corrupted Suicune.
- Suicune can be killed or captured. Healing him yields a Water/Grass form. A unique mystic sabre enables Behemoth Blade, the intended solution to a final water-demon boss.
- The game remains finishable without Suicune, but that victory leads to a darker ending with harm the player cannot repair.
- Ordinary poison cures, Full Heals, and normal Pokémon Centre recovery do not belong in the intended game loop.
- Timed fire recovery and journeys into a foggy astral plane replace the familiar recovery structure. Fallen companions must be found, fought, and caught again, with a severely limited opportunity.
- A late magical cemetery preserves fallen companions. Its shrine master can fight with the player's actual lost Pokémon and has his own impressive team when needed.
- The final shrine concerns facing oneself and discovering one's own capacity for corruption.
- Mother imbued an existing human protagonist with water magic or a curse. This enables astral traversal and makes the protagonist partly akin to the demons, which cling to them as a vessel.
- The demons were once peaceful inhabitants of the land. Human greed, ancient and present, produced their suffering and the present haunting.
- The story makes the demons' grievance convincing. The protagonist nevertheless chooses to protect people because innocents suffer and human kinship remains stronger.

3. The sea, magic, death, and personhood

3.1 The sea herself

Confirmed. The sea is a majestic dark presence, treated as an entity rather than scenery. Her beauty, scale, and terror belong together. Learning the history of particular demons must not reduce her to a completely explained machine or a single villain with a comprehensible agenda.

Open. Her precise relation to the Water/Ghost legendary: manifestation, inhabitant, emissary, vessel, or something else. The legendary and the final water-demon boss have not been established as the same creature. Do not merge them by default.

Proposed presentation. The sea can appear unusually still when it should be rough. A wave can arrive without the expected preceding sound. A light can remain below the water after the lighthouse beam passes. Use such events sparingly and without an immediate explanation. The largest terrors need not fit into a sprite.

3.2 The water demons

Confirmed. Their origin lies in formerly peaceful inhabitants harmed through human greed. Ancient actions and contemporary actions belong to the same causal history. Their grievance is real; their present violence also reaches people who did not commit the original wrong.

Open. Whether all these former inhabitants were human, Pokémon, or a community including both. "Once peaceful inhabitants" must not silently become "every demon is a drowned human." The number of entities, their individual identities, and the process that transformed them remain to be designed.

Design interpretation. "Demon" can be the living population's name for a dangerous being, not an omniscient judgement about its original nature. Distinguish water-demon corruption from ordinary Ghost Pokémon and ordinary Water Pokémon. Lapras's Ghost typing alone does not make it malevolent.

3.3 The protagonist's condition

Confirmed. The protagonist existed as a person before Mother imbued them with water magic. The curse explains their ability to traverse the astral plane and return. At first, this ability appears to be a fortunate coincidence. Much later, the mother's intervention becomes known. Their affinity makes them an available vessel for the demons and explains why they occupy a special position in the final conflict.

Confirmed addition. The ritual keeps the protagonist forever a child. Mother is a believer in the water entities' mythology and did not perform it strictly for the child's sake. Her guilt contributed to years of overprotective care and gentle containment. Her own advanced age now makes continued containment impossible, so she begins preparing the protagonist to venture out.

Open. The ritual's exact religious purpose, date, circumstances, price, Mother's full knowledge, and whether she intended the final confrontation. Saving a dying child remains an unconfirmed earlier idea and cannot serve as a complete account of her motive. The protagonist's chronological age, subjective experience of

time, and whether childhood arrest affects psychological development need deliberate decisions. Arrested ageing does not imply invulnerability or contradict the established death mechanics. Do not turn the already existing child into a magically manufactured person.

Proposed dramatic emphasis. The revelation should alter the meaning of care received at home. It need not erase that care. Love and a violation of the child's autonomy can coexist, but the story must establish the actual circumstances before judging them.

3.4 Pseudo-Koga's different origin

Confirmed. The imitation is a conjured construction of poison magic. No existing Koga-person was transformed into it. Real Koga's whereabouts remain unknown. Its apparent familiarity initially encourages the protagonist to imagine a shared condition, making the eventual distinction painful.

Continuity rule. Participation in the astral plane cannot prove that a figure contains the soul of the person it resembles. The shared quest is an experience of apparent companionship, not reliable evidence that Koga has returned. Explain enough about the villagers' act to settle the imitation's origin without answering every metaphysical question about magical behaviour.

The required distinction concerns origin and identity. Do not soften the reveal with a last-minute fragment of real Koga secretly surviving inside the clone. The player's grief over the reunion remains valid even though that reunion was false.

3.5 Poison as defence and contamination

Confirmed. Koga discovers that Poison Pokémon help against demonic enemies. The winter town's later pollution visibly demonstrates a real defensive effect. Rumours claim prolonged exposure can poison the mind.

Open. The specific battle effect, environmental mechanism, and truth of the mental-corruption rumour. The rumour does not establish the cause of real Koga's disappearance. Pseudo-Koga's deterioration does not retrospectively prove that ordinary Poison Pokémon make every trainer cruel.

Proposed distinction. Careful handling of a dangerous defensive substance contrasts with uncontrolled saturation. Koga's skill can involve restraint, observation, and care for his Pokémon. The imitation can turn one useful discovery into an absolute rule: more poison means more safety. This supports the theme while preserving the real Koga's warmth.

3.6 The astral plane

Confirmed. A foggy soul world where the protagonist can appear after death and search for fallen companions. These companions roam and must be fought and caught again. The realm also supports a significant shared quest with pseudo-Koga.

Proposed geography. Astral spaces echo living places without matching them perfectly. A familiar path may reach a shore that does not exist above. A home may have the shape of a remembered doorway but no interior. Repeated motifs establish a relationship between the worlds without requiring a complete cosmological diagram.

Open. Whether every dead being enters this plane, what disappearance beyond recovery means, how time behaves there, and whether the sea contains or merely touches it. Do not make speculative answers necessary to understand ordinary quest objectives.

4. History and the present crisis

4.1 Historical anchors

Confirmed sequence, with dates open. Peaceful inhabitants once lived in the land. Ancient human greed harmed them and contributed to their transformation into haunting entities. Later generations inherited a damaged world. Present exploitation renews or worsens the older injury. The criminal organisation eventually unleashes water demons through desperation and recklessness.

Shrines, old masters, the mother's magic, and the legendary belong to the region's larger mystery. Their exact historical relationships are not yet fixed. A legend spoken by a villager is not automatically an objective account.

4.2 Proposed historical outline

The inhabited coast. The places later found underwater were once places of ordinary life. Proposed environmental evidence includes household thresholds, shared paths, worked stone, and objects showing relations between people and Pokémon. Their former inhabitants should become imaginable before their suffering becomes exposition.

The ancient taking. A powerful human group extracted something or appropriated a place at others' expense. A drowned settlement, broken compact, or sacrificial protection scheme are possible explanations. None has been selected. The eventual choice should make material self-interest legible and connect to what the present criminals want.

The age of keeping. Proposed: later communities developed practices that contained danger without fully repairing the wrong. Lamps, bells, offerings, incense, and maintained thresholds could survive as habits. This would explain why neglected everyday duties matter. It does not establish that every shrine master participated in the ancient crime.

The thinning settlements. Present poverty, abandoned buildings, unreliable travel, and diminished protection create opportunities for predation. Exact causes of depopulation remain open; avoid attributing every missing resident to one supernatural event.

The present breach. Criminal interference crosses a threshold that local practices had kept partially closed. The act must be concrete enough to investigate and stop repeating. It should arise from the organisation's established exploitation, not from an unrelated villain appearing late.

4.3 Proposed causal chain

The following is a proposed connection between confirmed arcs:

1. Criminal control of supplies and routes makes isolated settlements more vulnerable.

2. Sacred objects or submerged valuables become profitable targets. Early disturbances expose people to limited demonic danger.
3. Koga's poison defence offers a practical local answer, and communities increasingly depend on him.
4. Koga disappears for reasons the game never establishes. The crisis continues without him.
5. Desperate villagers attempt the poison conjuration. Its apparent success encourages dependence on the imitation.
6. Pseudo-Koga expands the defence until the winter town becomes toxic. Water carries contamination into the cherished forest.
7. The player confronts Suicune's corruption, then the false protector. Exposing the conjuration resolves that deception only.
8. The larger criminal breach and its consequences drive the descent toward the ancient coast and the final demons.

The timing of the major breach can move. The fixed requirement is that Koga's defence, the villagers' desperation, organised predation, and the later water crisis belong to one connected world. Criminals do not have to explain Koga's disappearance to connect these arcs.

5. Region, geography, and settlements

5.1 Regional structure

Confirmed. A new region includes a coastal starting town, a large forest, a snowy mountain dojo settlement, at least one other town central to the Koga storyline, underwater exploration, shrines, and an astral realm.

Proposed organising geography. A watershed connects snowy heights to streams, forest, river settlement, estuary, and sea. The great forest occupies much of the middle of the map. This makes travel and later contamination comprehensible. The mountain is visible from some lowland clearings; the lighthouse remains a distant reference from parts of the coast.

The region should fold back through earlier places as abilities and knowledge change. Exact compass positions, distances, town count, map scale, route names, and regional name remain open. Do not interpret the following list as a finished overworld map.

5.2 Shiohama: the starting town

Confirmed role; working name. A poor, partly deserted coastal town, close enough to the lighthouse that Mother and child have ordinary obligations to its remaining residents. It establishes deprivation, the sea's dominance, and the small scale of early help. Its other permanent human inhabitants are all old; the eternally young protagonist is the exception. The reason for the village's age distribution remains open. Do not infer that every resident participated in the ritual.

Prototype. The opening includes the keeper's house, lantern room, coastal village, oil seller, pier apparition, and route toward the forest. The oil errand teaches relationships and geography before a heroic identity develops.

Proposed town character. Salt has whitened wood and stone. Some shutters remain closed even during business hours. A few residents maintain places whose former purpose exceeds the remaining population. An abandoned rail halt is an earlier proposal, not a required feature or confirmed regional technology choice.

Potential residents include someone who sells lamp oil, a person waiting for a boat that no longer calls, and a neighbour who remembers Mother before the protagonist does. These are roles for development, not final named characters.

Confirmed opening revision, implemented in prototype 0.4.0. The player begins in their bedroom playing with Wick the Natu. Mother enters and asks them to come to the main hall. Makuhita is visibly moving boxes while she talks about letting the child explore alone; she pauses to scold his sloppiness sweetly. She suggests taking Pookie the Poochyena for a walk.

Pookie sleeps outside beside the lighthouse. She follows the player for a walk of 100 actual steps around the village. Only if they approach the pier does she bark at an unseen presence and run to its end. Speaking to her there restores following. This implies that she senses Lapras, without showing the player a creature. The detour is optional: the walk can finish without going near the pier. Returning home together after 100 steps completes it; returning without Pookie does not.

Mother, Natu and Makuhita are at home when the pair returns. Mother explains that the world is unsafe and permits the player to choose one of their three familiar companions. Only after selection does she ask for lamp oil. The seller stands beside his locked shop: he has lost its keys again in the northern forest. The player finds them among white flowers as an actual Key Item and returns them. He unlocks the door and goes inside; the player must enter to obtain the oil. Bringing it to Mother and tending the great lamp continues the domestic lesson. This order supersedes the earlier post-lamp companion choice.

Confirmed foreshadowing direction. Elderly residents make apparently affectionate comments about the protagonist's unchanged youth, such as "You're always looking young as ever!" Exact wording remains editable. A few such remarks should acquire their full meaning only later. Which residents know the truth, and how much they know, remain open.

Narrative uses. Establish home, display criminal pressure through ordinary needs, stage Lapras's first frightening encounter, and provide a return location where the same familiar sea later looks different. The town should not begin with a professor's laboratory.

Confirmed expansion, prototype 0.6.0. Recovering the keys also earns a homemade pie on a borrowed ceramic plate. Mother and child share it at home. Returning the plate leads into the robbery and a southward pursuit, described in 10.7. Two visiting youths from the surrounding coast commit the theft; they are not additional young permanent residents of Shiohama. The familiar household and village remain the emotional centre.

5.3 The lighthouse and headland

Confirmed. This is the protagonist's home. Mother, an old woman, is its sole keeper. Earlier concept art showing a small garden house does not override the later lighthouse-home decision.

Working arrangement. The keeper's domestic rooms and lantern room belong to one lighthouse home on a separate headland. A safe, legible coastal approach gives leaving and returning emotional weight. Temporary separate map interiors are a game representation of that home.

Prototype and earlier proposal. A second lamp points down into the water. Its ultimate purpose remains open. It may eventually relate to keeping, recognition, or the curse, but none of those explanations is confirmed.

Proposed domestic details include drying cloth, an old maintenance routine, an unfinished meal, and a place where the companion habitually waits. Establish Mother's age through everyday action and accumulated knowledge, not only through cryptic speeches.

Confirmed vault seed. The lighthouse contains an unusually large secure vault. The protagonist first hears of it when the oil seller considers where to keep the recovered necklace and casually suggests Ellie's enormous vault. The vault's location within the building, purpose, construction, contents and connection to the lower lamp remain open. This milestone adds only the remark. No vault room, access puzzle or explanatory scene is implemented.

5.4 The Listening Wood: the great forest

Confirmed large forest; working name and central placement. Natu is common here. The forest contains riddles, routes, old places, and a cherished protected refuge. It must be substantial enough to remain important beyond one introductory route.

Prototype. Only an opening section exists, with a traveller's resting fire, a Natu encounter, a dangerous pool, and a northern endpoint. This is not the entire intended forest.

Proposed internal districts. The old road connects inhabited places; a rain village survives under the canopy; a bell grove retains an old ritual; a white clearing holds the protected refuge; deeper paths approach mountain watercourses. These earlier working ideas can be combined or reduced when the actual map develops.

Before pollution, give the refuge at least one meaningful visit: a quiet task, a conversation, an indirect glimpse of Suicune, or a remembered sound. After pollution, retain enough geometry and detail for recognition. The player should know what changed.

Natu's familiar abundance offers a useful measure of disturbance. Proposed: the refuge's first warning is the absence of its ordinary calls, before the player sees sludge. This is an atmospheric option, not a fixed species behaviour rule.

5.5 Frostbell: the winter dojo settlement

Confirmed role; working name. A mountain settlement of honourable warriors, with a dojo or monastic training tradition inspired by the user's Shaolin-town idea. Koga and his mother inspired the community's project. His mother is absent; his sister relates its history.

Proposed layout. Snowy courtyards, training areas, shared kitchens, sheltered paths, gardens, and a place associated with Koga's mother. Daily work should make the settlement feel inhabited and disciplined. Its inhabitants can be warm even when the landscape is austere.

Ninja Apprentices invite respectful practice. Their signature tone is: "You look honourable. Help me grow as a warrior!" They are not a route full of hostile guards. An earlier proposal allows the player to decline ordinary practice battles. Their concentration makes this area an exception to the game's generally sparse trainer density.

Confirmed transformation. Pseudo-Koga poisons the settlement to defend it. The white town becomes purple with toxins and green with sludge. The defence must have a perceptible benefit against demons, so initial acceptance has a reason. The resulting sickness and environmental harm make that protection intolerable.

Proposed aftermath. Survivors clear one path or restore a shared room. The town need not instantly return to pristine white after the boss. Its altered state can register both damage and the beginning of repair.

5.6 Reed Hollow: the second Koga settlement

Confirmed need for a second town; working name and river geography. This community gives the Koga story a social world beyond the dojo. The leading outline places the villagers responsible for the conjuration here, although the exact participants and ritual site remain open.

Proposed character. A lowland river settlement depends on threatened routes and outside defenders. Reeds, damp workshops, moored boats, and patched communal buildings distinguish it from Frostbell. Residents know Koga through practical help, rather than primarily as a teacher or brother.

The village should contain different responses to his absence: someone searches, someone organises ordinary defence, someone demands a supernatural solution, and someone doubts it but stays silent. Avoid making "the villagers" a single mind with identical knowledge and guilt.

This is a strong location for contradictory return rumours, traces of preparation, and the eventual testimony that establishes the clone's origin. Those revelations should not also reveal where real Koga went.

5.7 The cherished refuge

Confirmed. A treasured, protected part of the forest becomes badly poisoned. An old guardian is dying. A rare, beautiful Pokémon has been corrupted. The player must confront the creature before the pseudo-Koga boss.

Open. The guardian's species or human identity, name, duties, and ultimate fate. "Dying" describes the encounter, not an already approved ending to every attempt to help the guardian.

The refuge should represent more than a container for Suicune. Its local relationships, wildlife, water, and customs should make the loss legible even if the player never catches him.

5.8 Beyond the Shore: astral spaces

Confirmed realm; prototype map name. Fog, roaming lost companions, uncertain distances, and recognisable fragments of living geography. The first visit teaches the cost of death. Later visits can carry story, including the shared pseudo-Koga quest.

Proposed expansion. Create several compact astral spaces with distinct relationships to nearby living places. They should not all be colour-filtered duplicates. The late cemetery can provide a more stable point of contact with loss; its exact relation to the astral plane remains open.

5.9 The submerged land

Confirmed need for Dive and late ancient revelations; proposed specific sites. A drowned settlement, submerged shrine approaches, and remains of ordinary habitation make the demons' former life tangible. The precise catastrophe that placed them underwater remains open.

Proposed exploration moves from navigable human-scale remains toward spaces that resist familiar interpretation. Environmental discoveries should establish historical evidence before the legendary account expands its meaning.

5.10 The final cemetery shrine

Confirmed. A very late shrine acts as a magical cemetery and a gallery of the player's fallen Pokémon. Its master tests the player's ability to face themselves, using lost companions when available.

Open. Name, location, architecture, relation to the water, and whether the gallery is reached from the living world, astral plane, or both. Do not place it permanently until the late traversal route is coherent.

5.11 City 2: the dock city

Confirmed future canon; numbered working designation. City 2 is an important, potentially principal dock city. Its identity centres on shipping, coastal trade, warehouses, salvage, and the movement of goods between isolated coastal settlements. Illegal resale and distribution operate alongside ordinary trade.

Team Abyss maintains a theft, fencing and illegal-distribution operation here. The small storehouse in the necklace quest belongs to this wider network. Early thieves mention buyers at the docks without explaining the city's full importance. Later exploration should make the economics of that network comprehensible.

Confirmed future canon: the museum. City 2 contains an important museum that becomes a major narrative location. It publicly displays the unique mystic sabre already connected to healed Suicune and the better final resolution. The museum's possession must eventually make historical sense, but its complete provenance remains undecided. Team Abyss later steals the sabre with incomplete understanding; see 7.5 and 10.6.

Open. Final city and museum names, exact map, population, curatorial details, full quest structure, heist timing and staging. The city and museum are not built in 0.6. The short southbound pursuit route leads in their direction without fixing a complete regional map.

5.12 City 4: a hometown mentioned over food

Confirmed connection; numbered working designation. City 4 is the oil seller's hometown and the source of the pie recipe. It first enters dialogue as an ordinary place someone comes from. The borrowed plate may later offer regional visual recognition there.

Prototype choice. The plate has two blue reeds painted on its rim. This is ordinary household pottery, not a magical object. Its recognisable design is available for later City 4 ceramics. City 4's final name, location, broader identity and quests remain open. Do not equate it with Frostbell or Reed Hollow merely because of its number or the painted reeds.

6. Character dossiers

6.1 The protagonist

Confirmed. Mother's child, raised in the lighthouse, apparently fortunate in their ability to return through the astral plane. Later they discover that their water curse makes them partly kin to the entities threatening the region. They ultimately protect human innocents despite recognising the demons' grievance.

Confirmed. The protagonist remains a child because of Mother's ritual. Their chronological age and awareness of the elapsed years remain open; do not infer a specific number of decades or a fixed adult mind in a child's body.

Prototype. Ren is a provisional default name, changeable through the opening journal. Exact apparent age, gender presentation, visual design, and final naming conventions remain open.

Proposed arc. A person begins with obligations close to home, becomes useful to strangers, mistakes usefulness for an obligation to save everything, and eventually accepts limits without abandoning care. Their relationship with pseudo-Koga offers an apparent escape from isolation: someone seems to understand being altered by magic. The cemetery tests whether accepting loss can coexist with continued action.

Do not make every player action morally wrong to force this arc. Their capacity for corruption is a question raised by their situation, not an accusation that ordinary exploration or unavoidable defeat proves wickedness.

6.2 Mother, the keeper

Confirmed. An elderly mother and the lighthouse's sole keeper. She believes in the water entities' mythology. She imbued the already existing protagonist with water magic for reasons not limited to the child's welfare. The ritual keeps the protagonist forever a child. Its nature and her complicity become clear only much later.

Her guilt made her exceptionally careful and overprotective. The familiar safety of home has also been gentle containment. She now recognises that she is very old and does not have long, so she must allow the protagonist to leave and learn to live beyond her care.

Early presentation. She says the child is old enough to explore the world and wants to teach them some things while she still can. After the first walk with Pookie, she permits one of the three house pets to accompany them. The oil and lamp lesson follows this choice. This should initially feel like an intimate family transition. Neither she nor the interface openly explains the ritual, guilt, or permanent childhood here.

Working name: Ellie. The protagonist still addresses her as Mother. The oil seller uses Ellie casually after the necklace is recovered.

Open. Final name, precise religious objective beyond the established mixed motive, ritual circumstances, relationship with the legendary, what she knows about the ancient wrong, and her final fate. She is not confirmed dead, sacrificed, secretly nonhuman, or the creator of the sea.

Proposed character direction. Practical affection, fatigue, old habits, and withheld knowledge. Let her speak plainly about oil, weather, and food. Occasional evasions then have more force. Her confession should answer specific questions about the protagonist rather than deliver the entire region's cosmology.

6.3 Koga, the real friend

Confirmed. Young, lively, warm, ambitious, and exceptionally talented. His discovery gives communities a useful defence. He helps the protagonist for a meaningful part of the journey before disappearing completely.

Relationship requirement. The player must know his actual Pokémon team well. Establish its members through several encounters and small behaviours. Final species and moves are open; record them as stable character facts once chosen. A brief single battle will not provide enough familiarity for the later absence to carry its intended weight.

Proposed behaviour. He enjoys progress, praises effort, talks to his own Pokémon naturally, and can admit that an experiment failed. His ambition should feel generous and alive. His eventual absence must not retroactively turn every earlier kindness into a clue that he was secretly corrupt.

Intentional mystery. His destination and fate. Do not provide a body, a final explanatory letter, an authenticated afterlife appearance, a hidden rescue, or an ending cameo that resolves the disappearance. Rumours may persist without becoming proof.

Open continuity. His relation to the familiar franchise character. Do not assume this is a canonical prequel or force later franchise events to explain his disappearance.

6.4 Koga's sister

Confirmed. A major character, a trainer the player can battle, and a source of stories about Koga and their absent mother. Her name, age, team, and final personal arc remain open.

Proposed role. She sustains the settlement while its charismatic prodigy travels. She knows his ordinary habits and his Pokémon, giving her a different basis for recognising discrepancies in the returned figure. She can want the reunion to be true without immediately trusting every aspect of it.

Her choices should influence the settlement: protecting apprentices, resisting escalating poison, investigating, or helping survivors. Do not make her only a source of exposition or a hostage. Do not automatically name her after an existing franchise character.

6.5 Koga's mother

Confirmed. She and Koga inspired the settlement's project. She is no longer there; his sister preserves the stories.

Open. Whether she died, left, vanished, or is absent for another reason. Her philosophy and what Koga understood or misunderstood about it need development. She and the protagonist's mother are different people; no relationship between them has been established.

6.6 Pseudo-Koga

Confirmed. The poison construction appears to restore the lost friend. It initially feels convincing and close, then acts out of character, becomes cruel and brutal, and deteriorates into a disfigured, cloudlike poison horror. Its final team is entirely different from real Koga's familiar team.

Proposed dramatic progression. It first provides useful help, then justifies a small disproportionate act as protection, then treats disagreement as danger, and finally attempts to make protection total. Let earlier affection be experienced fully before suspicion dominates.

The boss must resolve the immediate threat. Later evidence establishes the villagers' conjuration and confirms that this was never the returned real Koga. The player destroys the appearance of a dear friend, then learns that the original search has not advanced to an answer.

6.7 The villagers behind the conjuration

Confirmed. Desperate villagers attempt poison magic to bring back Koga and create the imitation instead.

Proposed character distribution. An organiser makes the decision; a participant supplies something necessary; a dissenter fails to stop the ritual; a resident believes the public account without knowing the method. These roles make responsibility specific without requiring a large cast.

Their actions should be understandable through what they fear and have already lost. Their desperation does not erase responsibility. Their later testimony should contain concrete evidence, not merely a rumour competing with all the others.

6.8 The old forest guardian

Confirmed. Dying amid the polluted refuge, the guardian identifies the corruption of its rare resident and gives the player a reason to act. Identity and final fate are open.

Proposed direction. The guardian remembers the place as a lived relationship rather than a treasure to possess. If human, give them ordinary duties and memories. If a Pokémon or spirit, establish how communication works before relying on a long explanation.

6.9 Travelling ninjas and apprentices

Confirmed concept. Travelling ninjas or comparable figures maintain small fires for limited recovery. Ninja Apprentices form a respectful trainer class near the mountain settlement.

Proposed distinction. Travellers connect scattered places through practical knowledge; apprentices seek growth through training. They need not all belong to one formal organisation. A recurring traveller can anchor trust without replacing the missing rival or accompanying the player continuously.

6.10 Criminal leaders and local people

Open names and cast. The organisation needs recognisable agents of predation, but Team Abyss is now the approved working name; no leader, executive roster or final uniform is approved. Local civilians need roles before biographies: a keeper, a seller, a boat operator, an apprentice, a bereaved neighbour, a caretaker.

Proposed economy of character. Revisit a modest cast as their circumstances change. A short altered line in a place the player remembers can carry more weight than introducing another tragic stranger at every turn.

6.11 The cemetery master

Confirmed. The final shrine leader presents a battle drawn from the player's fallen Pokémon when possible and otherwise uses an impressive team of his own. His trial concerns self-recognition and corruption.

Open. Identity, name, history, team, and relation to earlier masters. A gentle manner is an earlier proposal, not settled dialogue. The master need not accuse or explain everything for the encounter to be severe.

6.12 The oil seller

Confirmed. A sympathetic elderly neighbour in Shiohama, originally from City 4. Forgetful about his keys, overgenerous with food, mildly comic and sincerely grateful. His painful or ageing legs prevent him from chasing the two thieves. He remains polite even while distressed and notices the returned plate in the middle of the crisis.

The stolen pearl necklace belonged to his deceased wife. He reveals this only after its recovery, in restrained ordinary language. Her death has no fixed date. His wife, his own final name and their wider biography remain open.

Emotional role. He represents healthy attachment to someone who is gone. Keeping a beloved object and missing its wearer do not imply corruption. He wants the necklace back; he does not try to resurrect his wife or refuse the reality of her death. This provides a quiet counterpoint to later forms of destructive protection and conjuration.

He knows Mother as Ellie and knows the lighthouse has a very large vault. He also knows of the dock-city museum. His sources for those ordinary facts are not specified. Neither he nor the player understands the pearls' deeper significance. His knowledge is particular, never an excuse to deliver omniscient lore.

Recurring narrative role. Oil seller, home, southbound road, local theft, City 2's distribution, City 4's food and later magical ecology become connected through a neighbour's life. He does not knowingly introduce the final plot.

6.13 The early thieves

Confirmed tone and role. Two inexperienced young thieves from the surrounding coast have begun associating with Team Abyss. They are rude, opportunistic, bad liars and recognisably comic in the manner of early Pokémon antagonists. They know the lighthouse child locally but do not become a rival or traveling companion.

Prototype names and rosters. Toma uses a level-5 Rattata; Ivo uses a level-7 Poochyena. Bram, a petty storehouse runner, uses a level-6 Zigzagoon. These are adjustable implementation choices, not permanent character designs. A packer and lookout add several voices without requiring a battle against every criminal. Stock trainer art does not establish the organisation's final uniform.

7. Pokémon and the regional Pokédex

7.1 Dex principles

Confirmed. The game has a custom dex with regional variants and additional original development. Its size, generation coverage, complete species list, and availability curve remain open.

Design interpretation. Species should contribute to place, daily life, or a major relationship. Ordinary creatures must remain ordinary enough for exceptional ones to stand out. Not every Pokémon needs a horrific regional form. A familiar Natu or a companion's habitual movement can provide continuity within the darkness.

New forms require more than recolouring: narrative role, ecology, readable silhouette, battle function, and an acquisition route. Exact stats and learnsets belong in species specifications once approved, rather than being guessed here.

7.2 Regional Lapras

Confirmed type and arc: Water/Ghost.

First encounter: fear. The player encounters a ghost before understanding a companion. The event should feel wrong in a place that seemed familiar. The existing pier glimpse is a prototype of this beat, not the final sprite or complete encounter.

Later: attachment. The player learns to love Lapras. This requires repeated acts or experiences that establish character beyond a useful traversal ability. Proposed moments include waiting nearby, recognising the protagonist, or guiding them through a frightening passage. Exact recruitment and party status remain open.

Then: the unsettling fact. Something about Lapras becomes deeply disturbing after attachment forms. Its precise content is still open. New proposals include an involuntary link through which the sea recognises the protagonist or the burden of carrying traces of the drowned. These must remain proposals; no betrayal or concealed appetite is confirmed.

Near the end: the legendary connection. Lapras is revealed as imbued with the Water/Ghost legendary's magic. This should reinterpret earlier signs without cancelling the experiences that made it beloved.

Current visual direction (0.7.8). The user requested a direct edit of original Lapras: white and ghostly, recognisable silhouette, restrained mist and a distinctive head mark. The implemented draft uses a cold-cream body, mist-grey shell, jade-green eye and small faded-yellow forehead scar. This supersedes the earlier indigo-shell/ring-marking proposal. Preserve an expression capable of tenderness. The mark has no established lore explanation; do not invent one. See section 26 for implementation scope.

7.3 Natu, Xatu, and the regional evolution

Confirmed. Natu is the common regional bird, filling the everyday encounter role often held by Pidgey. A special item allows a powerful regional evolution after Xatu. This is a further evolution, not merely an alternative evolution replacing Xatu.

Open. Name, typing, ability, stats, appearance, item, and acquisition conditions. Dawn Glass and a traveller-like Psychic/Flying design are earlier working proposals. No final species data follows from those suggestions.

Proposed thematic role. An ordinary companion can develop into something suited to travelling between difficult places. This would let an early, familiar creature remain important without requiring a legendary. Its power must not quietly duplicate Suicune's unique hopeful-ending function.

Prototype 0.5.1. Wick, a level-7 Natu, first plays with the child in their bedroom and is one of three household companions available after Pookie's walk. The automatic starting Natu remains only in legacy saves. Names and levels are provisional. Natu remains the common regional bird regardless of the eventual starter decision; choosing a household individual need not make the species exclusive. Borrowed and fallback Natu in the astral mechanics remain separate gameplay accommodations.

7.3a The three house pets

Confirmed structure. These are already familiar household Pokémon, not strangers handed out by an external expert. Mother lets one accompany the protagonist after Pookie's walk, before the oil errand. The creative director prefers existing two-stage evolutionary lines so a custom third stage can be added. Three permanent final evolutions, rather than temporary transformations, are the design direction; custom third-stage designs remain open.

User candidates. Natu, the Meditite/Medicham line, and a possible Dark-type third companion. Meditite is the unevolved member of the Medicham line. Both it and Natu have Psychic typing, so choosing them together would create an intentional overlap.

Selected for the playable opening. Following the recommendation, the creative director authorized implementation. The 0.4.0 trio is Natu to Xatu (Psychic/Flying), Makuhita to Hariyama (Fighting), and Poochyena to Mightyena (Dark), with a custom third evolution planned for each line. The current nicknames are Wick, Maku and Pookie, all level 7; these names and balancing values are provisional. The suggested household roles are a quiet watchful bird, an affectionate helper with physical strength, and a loyal dog that guards the door. Possible final themes are a seer, a mountain guardian, and a supernatural watchdog. None of these themes fixes final typing, art, or species names.

Psychic, Fighting and Dark form an offensive advantage cycle, but not the symmetrical interaction of a simple starter triangle. Dark is immune to Psychic, and Natu's Flying typing changes the matchups further. Meditite's Psychic secondary type also changes its weaknesses. Balance should focus on the full journey and early move access, not merely three type labels. Each choice needs usable early answers to spectral enemies; a Fighting choice must not become helpless against Ghost Pokémon.

Alternative proposal. Keep Meditite in the trio if its meditative character matters more than distinct typings, or reserve it for the mountain community. Do not assign it to Koga's sister's team without a later decision.

7.4 Corrupted Suicune

Confirmed creature and arc. A very rare, beautiful Suicune in the cherished forest becomes thoroughly corrupted by poison. The player can kill him or catch him. Capture opens a healing responsibility.

Working corrupted typing: Water/Poison. The poison form was proposed during development; exact species implementation and battle properties remain open. The healed **Water/Grass** form is confirmed.

Proposed presentation. Retain beauty beneath damage. Familiar flowing forms can become heavy, stained, or painfully interrupted. The restored form should show recovery and new life rather than merely reversing a colour filter. Its association with grass and living water should be visible without cluttering the silhouette.

Healing must have an intelligible process. Its ingredients, places, duration, and possible intermediate behaviour are open. Do not make capture itself instantly cure the forest or everything downstream.

7.5 The mystic sabre and Behemoth Blade

Confirmed. Giving Suicune a unique mystic sabre enables Behemoth Blade. This is the intended way to destroy a final water-demon boss and achieve the more hopeful resolution.

Open. The sabre's final name, origin, complete museum provenance, visual design, eligibility rules, and precise move interaction. Its public display in the City 2 museum and later theft by Team Abyss are now confirmed future canon. A special strike that severs a restorative veil or persistent supernatural connection is an earlier proposal. It is not implemented or fixed.

The ordinary battle move and the story-specific interaction must agree. A generic source of the same move must not accidentally unlock the unique narrative result unless deliberately approved. The resolution depends on this Suicune's recovery and the sabre's intended use, not merely on a menu displaying a move name.

7.6 Legendary and final demons

Confirmed. A Water/Ghost legendary's magic is connected to Lapras. Final confrontations involve water-demon boss Pokémon. The intended Suicune solution concerns a final boss.

Open. Legendary species, name, personality, history, form, availability for capture, relation to the sea, and whether it is among the final opponents. The number and order of final bosses remain open. Preserve room for the sea to exceed any one encounter.

7.7 Koga's Pokémon as characters

Confirmed requirement. The player knows real Koga's team well; pseudo-Koga's boss team shares none of those familiar team members. Do not explain the difference as an ordinary competitive team update.

Proposed rule. Once selected, give real Koga's team distinctive species and recognisable individual behaviours. Use an entirely different species roster for the clone to make the clue legible. Preserve the original team in the character record even if levels and moves develop.

7.8 Ordinary danger

Confirmed. Wild Pokémon can genuinely threaten communities. The regional ecology must permit frightening, hostile encounters without treating every dangerous animal as possessed.

Proposed encounter variety. Territorial danger, hunger, injury, displacement, criminal exploitation, and supernatural corruption create different problems. Some can be redirected or helped; some require fighting. A late demon should feel different from an ordinary creature guarding its young.

8. Factions, danger, and everyday life

8.1 The criminal organisation

Confirmed. It loots and preys on poor, deserted communities. Its desperation and stupidity unleash water demons. Its actions interweave with the Koga story and ancient mystery.

Working name: Team Abyss.

Open. Final name, emblem, leadership, recruitment details, broader geography, and final fate. Do not create a conventional eight-city criminal campaign merely to resemble another Pokémon game.

Proposed operations. Control of boats, lamp fuel, valuable salvage, and access to supplies gives the team visible local power. Theft from shrines links material greed to old protections. A lack of conventional poison cures does not prevent conflict over food, shelter, clean water, or other supplies.

The organisation can be socially organised and still catastrophically ignorant. Its members need not have a coherent plan to summon an apocalypse. A decision to force one more passage or remove one more valuable object can have consequences they neither wanted nor understood.

Confirmed gradual introduction. The necklace quest shows petty theft, resale, packing, local jobs and foolish hierarchy before supernatural consequences. The south-coast storehouse routes coastal goods toward buyers at the docks. Its criminals lack a grand speech or coherent apocalypse plan. Later, the same infrastructure gives the organisation access to more consequential objects, including the museum's sabre. Recognition of potential value or power does not equal understanding.

8.2 The dojo community

Confirmed. Honourable warriors, a culture of practice, and Koga's useful discovery distinguish the mountain town. The settlement is capable of warmth and ambition before its corruption.

Proposed internal tension. Some residents value training as responsibility; others increasingly want certainty from one prodigy. The latter dependence makes his absence politically and emotionally destabilising. This tension must not imply that every apprentice embraces the clone's actions.

8.3 The old masters

Confirmed. They can entrust powers to a worthy challenger. Most later masters appear through incense only for the fight. Their empty shrines bear the trace of a former social order.

Open. Whether they shared an institution, how old they are, why each shrine is empty, and what each knows about the ancient wrong. Their collective history should not become an exposition shortcut that solves every mystery at once.

8.4 Ordinary life under pressure

Design interpretation. Poverty should be specific: missing labour, threatened transport, damp houses, an unmaintained path, or reliance on one defender. Residents still work, joke, disagree, train, care for Pokémon, and make choices. Suffering alone cannot establish a community worth protecting.

Show the cost of predation through what it prevents people from doing. Show successful help through what people resume. This makes the protagonist's eventual decision to side with humans an extension of lived relationships.

9. Full story outline

Proposed chapter order. The events marked confirmed elsewhere remain binding. These chapter divisions, transitions, and timing choices organise them into a coherent journey; they are not all separate approved maps or completed quests.

Chapter I: The keeper's child

Before the player wakes, a sleeping Natu appears against darkness. It opens one eye. The words are: "A bird wants to play." The player guides Natu through a small, dim spirit maze towards the protagonist asleep in bed. Reaching the bedside dissolves this scene. The player then wakes in an apparently ordinary Gen 3 bedroom. Its exit returns them to the centre; its furnishings speak in impossible domestic fragments. Solving three consecutive bed questions and choosing to sleep for twelve years brings Wick into the room. Speaking to him leads into a larger, colder, fractured bedroom. Reaching its bed and answering four stranger questions opens the way into the established Natu hide-and-seek maze. A wrong answer in the second bedroom resets the whole attempt and returns the player to that room's entrance. The room forms a classic Pokémon maze with directional push tiles and teleporters. Reaching Natu ends the game: Mother calls from downstairs, and the player returns to the ordinary small bedroom. The maze appears only at the start of a new journey. Much later, the story explains that it was Natu's psychic projection; the opening does not disclose its cause. In the main hall, Makuhita moves boxes; Mother's affectionate scolding establishes their household life. No travelling companion has yet been chosen. Mother speaks of being old enough to explore and of the things she wants to teach while she still has time. The other village residents are elderly. Occasional remarks about the protagonist's unchanged youth initially pass as familiar affection.

Mother sends the child on a hundred-step walk with Pookie, who sleeps beside the lighthouse. Near the pier, an optional incident lets the dog sense something invisible and run away; the player brings her back by speaking to her. After they return home together, Mother permits a choice of Natu, Makuhita or Poochyena. She then asks for oil. The locked-out seller needs his keys recovered from the northern wood before he opens the shop and gives the bottle inside. The lamp lesson follows. Avoid mandatory combat before companion selection or on the keys route.

A homemade pie rewards the oil errand. Mother recognises it and shares it with the child; a household Pokémon hopes for a crumb. Returning its borrowed plate reveals a robbery. Helping the seller recover a necklace naturally carries the child south beyond the familiar opening area. The first opponent lies badly, loses and runs; a second leads to an ordinary criminal storehouse. Recovery first reveals the seller's quiet grief for his wife. A small pearl glint and an incidental vault remark await later reinterpretation, without changing the meal's sincere warmth.

Later lore reinterprets this permission: Mother's ritual arrested the child's ageing, her guilt sustained overprotection, and her impending loss of the ability to care now forces release. The opening does not state those truths. The sea dominates the surroundings before anyone explains it.

Pookie's optional pier reaction first suggests an unseen presence. A later pier visit can reveal Lapras as a ghostly horror; its identity and role remain unclear. Early encounters reveal both dangerous wild Pokémon and the human pressure on a poor settlement. Leaving home follows an obligation or local need rather than a professor's instruction.

Emotional purpose: establish a home worth returning to and a world that does not revolve around welcoming a new trainer.

Chapter II: The paths between people

The great forest introduces a larger region, Natu's ordinary presence, riddles, and limited resting places. The player helps people in small ways. One success and one failure can establish that outcomes differ.

An early death or story-supported encounter introduces astral traversal and companion recovery. The first account of the protagonist's unusual survival treats it as luck. Proposed: if the player never loses an optional battle, an alternate scene reveals the affinity without forcing the death of their Pokémon.

The player visits the cherished refuge while it remains beautiful. Early shrine activity introduces worthiness and incense. The exact first master and power remain open.

Emotional purpose: make the player vulnerable while showing why continuing to help has meaning.

Chapter III: Warmth in the snow

The player reaches the winter settlement. Koga is alive, lively, ambitious, and useful. His sister and the apprentices give him a place in a community. Stories about his mother establish a history beyond the protagonist's arrival.

Several encounters establish Koga's team and his discovery about poison defence. The player also visits the second settlement and sees why people depend on him. The organisation's exploitation links these journeys to the wider crisis.

Lapras begins moving from apparition toward trusted companion during this broad middle opening. The precise sequence may overlap with the mountain chapters.

Emotional purpose: allow a sustained period of affection and competence. Koga must not disappear immediately after his introduction.

Chapter IV: The missing protector

Koga disappears. His sister, the second village, forest routes, and people he helped offer leads. The player undertakes a significant search. It should include real discoveries and practical help, even though it will not reveal his fate.

Rumours suggest a return. Other rumours mention poison conjuring and something going wrong. Earlier warnings about poisoning the mind become tempting explanations. Do not authenticate any of these as an explanation of real Koga's disappearance.

As danger grows, the player understands why the community wants a defender back. The criminals' actions increase pressure without supplying a convenient answer to the mystery.

Emotional purpose: turn absence into a condition of travel, rather than a brief suspense beat before a guaranteed rescue.

Chapter V: The returned friend

The player finds the figure they believe is Koga. For a time, the reunion feels almost perfect. Both seem altered by magic, and the protagonist feels more understood than before. The player's own condition can be partially recognised here without revealing Mother's full role yet.

They share an astral-plane quest. Proposed: an escort or path-finding task lets them cooperate and talk in the fog, with a complete local objective. It must not require permanent loss of an established companion just to unlock the scene.

Something then breaks the familiar pattern. The returned figure acts off character, badly, or brutally. Escalation follows gradually enough for affection, doubt, and rationalisation to coexist.

Emotional purpose: make the later revelation destroy something the player experienced as real companionship.

Chapter VI: The poisoned sanctuary

The winter settlement's defensive poison expands. Snow becomes stained, sludge collects, and the protection's costs spread. The player learns that the cherished forest refuge has been badly poisoned and goes to help before the final confrontation with pseudo-Koga.

Poison Pokémon fill the changed area. The dying guardian identifies the corruption of Suicune. The player confronts him and chooses between the lethal route and capture. Capturing him begins healing, whose completion may extend into later chapters.

Proposed: evidence in the watershed connects the refuge's harm to the settlement's defence. Criminal pressure remains part of the circumstances but does not remove pseudo-Koga's responsibility for the poisoning.

Emotional purpose: make a supposedly protective act destroy something already loved. Establish the consequential Suicune branch before the finale advertises its reward.

Chapter VII: The shape of protection

The player confronts pseudo-Koga in the corrupted winter settlement. His insistence on protection has become destructive control. He deteriorates into a disfigured, cloudlike poison horror.

The boss team is entirely different from the real friend's familiar team. The absence is a crucial clue. The player defeats and destroys the false figure.

Later evidence, including the villagers' role, establishes that the returned protector was a conjured imitation. There was no real Koga inside it. The search for the actual friend remains unresolved, as it was before the reunion.

Some local harm can be reduced. The sister and surviving communities can continue. Those outcomes do not replace the missing person with a satisfying answer.

Emotional purpose: grief for a false return, horror at the destruction, and renewed solitude.

Chapter VIII: Beneath the familiar coast

The continuing criminal crisis and the ancient mystery draw the player toward Dive and submerged routes. The remains of former habitation establish what the demons once were and what human greed did.

Lapras's unsettling connection deepens after a genuine bond has formed. The legendary account arrives near the end of this larger discovery sequence. It explains the magical link while leaving the sea's deepest nature unresolved.

Mother's role in the protagonist's curse is revealed late, including her belief, her partly self-directed or religious motive, the arrest of childhood, and the guilt behind her overprotection. Her precise objective and confession remain open. The protagonist recognises why the demons cling to them and why they can face the final threat.

If Suicune was captured, the healing and sabre quests gain their late relevance. The no-Suicune route continues toward the same necessary confrontation.

Emotional purpose: establish a persuasive case for the demons' grievance and complicate the protagonist's identity.

Chapter IX: The last shrine

Very late in the journey, the magical cemetery presents the player's fallen companions. The final master fights with those Pokémon when enough exist, using his own team where necessary under the eventual selection rule.

The trial joins the stories of the villagers, pseudo-Koga, Mother, and the player. Each has confronted loss, protection, and the temptation to go too far. The player must face their own capacity for corruption without being told that every failure was a sin.

The encounter permits recognition or farewell. It does not automatically resurrect the permanently lost or produce the real Koga.

Emotional purpose: move from trying to undo every absence toward deciding how to act with a truthful understanding of oneself.

Chapter X: The people on the shore

The protagonist chooses to protect people. The demons' historical grievance remains valid, but innocent living people suffer and human kinship carries decisive weight.

Final water-demon confrontations remain winnable through ordinary capable play. A healed Suicune with the mystic sabre supplies the intended special resolution through Behemoth Blade. Without that solution, the player can win the fight yet leave something irreparable behind.

The ending shows concrete effects in places and relationships the player knows. Hope does not demand a complete explanation of the sea, a return of Koga, or the restoration of every dead companion.

Emotional purpose: a choice for continued care under incomplete knowledge and permanent loss.

10. Major quest structures

10.1 Lapras: four meanings of one companion

Confirmed sequence: frightening ghost, beloved presence, deeply unsettling revelation, late legendary explanation. Each stage must preserve what the preceding stage achieved.

Proposed progression. Recognition precedes trust; trust precedes reliance; reliance precedes the disturbing fact. Give the player at least one quiet, unnecessary interaction that expresses affection. Do not make every appearance an efficient ferry service or a lore delivery.

Open decisions: recruitment, capture rules, availability for battle, relation to Surf or Dive, exact unsettling truth, and final fate. Lapras must not become a mandatory invulnerable party slot merely because it has narrative importance.

10.2 Koga: a search with a false answer

Confirmed structure. Know the real friend and team; experience his disappearance; search across at least two towns; hear return and conjuration rumours; believe in the reunion; share astral companionship; witness cruelty; confront forest harm before the clone boss; destroy the imitation; learn its origin; remain unable to explain real Koga's fate.

Proposed clues. An altered response to an apprentice, an unfamiliar approach to a familiar Pokémon, or a protective action with a disproportionate cost. Use a few consistent discrepancies. Do not hide every clue until a final monologue.

Ending obligation. The quest can resolve the conjuration and help surviving residents. Its original goal, finding the real Koga, remains unfulfilled. Do not label the entire social recovery meaningless because the search has no answer.

10.3 The poisoned forest and Suicune

Confirmed structure. Establish the refuge, reveal contamination, meet the dying guardian, confront corrupted Suicune, permit killing or capture, and connect the damage to the wider Koga crisis. The confrontation precedes the pseudo-Koga boss.

Proposed choice handling. Distinguish battle defeat from deliberate killing. An explicit decision after subduing Suicune can prevent a normal attack from silently selecting an irreversible ending. The exact interface remains open. Make permanence clear enough to understand without announcing every late-game consequence.

Proposed healing structure. A short sequence of care, a meaningful place, and a resource obtained through helping or exploration. Avoid a long generic ingredient grind. Restored Suicune should participate in the relationship, rather than functioning only as a purchased ending key.

10.4 The criminal breach

Confirmed goal. Connect local predation to the act that unleashes the water demons and the late ancient mystery.

Proposed structure. A small early intervention reveals how the organisation controls a route or resource. Later evidence connects those operations to looting a protected place. A final attempt to force access causes or worsens the breach. The player deals with its consequences after defeating particular criminals.

Open. Whether the player witnesses the breach, arrives too late, or participates unknowingly. Do not blame the player for an unavoidable scripted act without giving the story a reason beyond manufactured guilt.

10.5 Mother and the lower lamp

Confirmed core: the lighthouse home, Mother's belief in the water mythology, her ritual for reasons beyond the child's welfare, arrested childhood, guilty overprotection, eventual release prompted by her age, and the late curse revelation. **Proposed link:** the downward lamp offers recurring evidence of her keeping practices.

The quest should move from ordinary routine to discrepancies, then specific questions, then an account of the protagonist's condition. Her precise religious aim within the established mixed motive and the lamp's function remain authorial decisions. The confession should not become a universal solution to every open mystery.

10.6 The sabre

Confirmed purpose: enable healed Suicune's Behemoth Blade and the intended final resolution. **Proposed timing:** make the sabre's significance legible after the player has already chosen whether to save Suicune.

Confirmed future canon, not implemented. The same unique sabre is publicly displayed in City 2's important museum. Later Team Abyss steals it, recognising unusual significance without understanding its function, Suicune's role or the final confrontation. This theft grows from their established dock-city access, fencing and distribution infrastructure. Its complete provenance and the circumstances of recovery remain open. Earlier suggestions involving shrines or submerged history may inform that provenance or recovery; they no longer leave its initial display location undecided.

Much later, recovery of or access to the sabre connects to healed Water/Grass Suicune, Behemoth Blade and the intended better resolution. Merely knowing the sabre exists must not expose this purpose early. No museum map, heist script, sabre item, Suicune interaction or ending implementation belongs to the necklace milestone.

10.7 The oil seller's plate and necklace

Confirmed immediate sequence, implemented in 0.6.0.

1. Retrieve the shop keys in the northern wood, return them, enter the shop and receive lamp oil. The seller also offers homemade pie on a distinctive ceramic plate and asks for the plate back. City 4 enters casually through the recipe.
2. Return the oil to Mother and share the pie. She recognises the cooking without explaining how. A remaining household Pokémon moves closer to the food. She washes the empty plate. The player retains it for return. The lamp lesson remains available in its existing order.

3. Returning the plate to the shop triggers two boys bursting out and fleeing south. The seller's short, unsuccessful chase exposes his aching legs. He notices the plate and thanks the child before asking, neighbour to neighbour, for help recovering a pearl necklace.
4. Follow the south coast road. Optional wild Pokémon precede the first thief. He recognises the lighthouse child, lies badly and battles. After defeat he accidentally admits the other boy has the necklace, then runs.
5. Farther south, the second boy enters an old storehouse. The player overhears several criminals discussing resale, boxes, pearls, petty hierarchy and buyers at the docks. The runner and second thief can be defeated; the player recovers the necklace.
6. Return it to the seller. Only now does he explain that his wife wore it on important and ordinary days. His grief is restrained. A single pearl briefly catches unusual light; he explains it as something pearls do.
7. Wondering where to keep it, he mentions the museum down at the docks, dismisses it as too important for this personal object, then casually suggests Ellie's huge lighthouse vault. He puts the necklace away. No vault purpose or museum quest is revealed.

The pearls: confirmed future meaning. The necklace is not a unique legendary artefact. It uses a particular kind of unusual pearl belonging to the deeper magical ecology, and many more exist. Neither seller nor protagonist understands this yet. Its emotional value comes from its wearer, not hidden power. Later recognition reveals that the deep magical world had long existed within ordinary human life. Do not call these pearls sacred, cursed, demonic, chosen or legendary in early content. Their specific ecology and name remain open.

Narrative method. Ordinary task → relationship → small reward → domestic warmth → new obligation → travel → mundane criminal conflict → personal meaning → delayed reinterpretation. Let the pie be pleasant and the thieves fun. Avoid turning every sentence into a clue or every form of mourning into corruption.

Long-range structure, recorded without later implementation. Early: seller → necklace → petty thieves → small Abyss operation → road toward City 2. Later: City 2 → docks/distribution → museum → publicly displayed sabre → Abyss theft. Much later: healed Suicune → recovery/access to sabre → Behemoth Blade → intended better final resolution. The player must not see this as a telegraphed chain at the beginning. Its force comes from revisiting familiar relationships with new knowledge.

11. Shrines, trials, and traversal

11.1 Structure

Confirmed. Old masters entrust powers after the player proves worthy. Most later shrines are empty. A special incense must first be found, then brought to summon a master only for the fight. There is no normal gym circuit.

Open. Number of shrines, individual masters, associated powers, exact incense varieties, and whether early masters are alive or appear by another method. The winter dojo's living trainer culture can coexist with mostly empty later shrines.

11.2 Proposed trial grammar

A local need or an obscure trace leads to incense. Reaching the shrine requires exploration or a riddle. The battle expresses the master's discipline. Victory grants permission, knowledge, or a field power. The community's response makes the outcome matter beyond a collectible emblem.

Possible trial themes include attention, restraint, endurance, keeping a promise, and recognising oneself. Only the final shrine's self-confrontation theme is confirmed. Avoid assigning one moral lesson to every type before the world and mechanics support it.

Proposed retry rule. Once a player has earned access, a failed battle should not automatically require farming another rare incense. Whether incense is consumed, renewable, or treated as a permanent qualification remains open.

11.3 Dive

Confirmed. Dive must exist as an HM or equivalent field ability. Underwater exploration is structurally important, not optional decoration.

Open. Who grants it, what shrine proves worthiness, which Pokémon can use it, and whether using it occupies a conventional move slot. Avoid making progression depend exclusively on an optional Pokémon that can be permanently lost. A compatible fallback route must preserve finishability without duplicating Suicune's unique ending role.

Other traversal powers and their sequence remain open. Use abilities to change the meaning and accessibility of familiar places; do not automatically recreate the franchise's complete HM list.

12. Death, recovery, and the cemetery

12.1 Intended recovery economy

Confirmed. No ordinary poison-healing items, Full Heals, or conventional Pokémon Centre reset. Small resting fires associated with travelling ninjas or comparable figures provide limited recovery at low HP. Death can first restore the player in the astral plane, where fallen Pokémon must be sought again.

Open. Treatment of ordinary Potions and other HP resources, status-curing moves, abilities, status-curing berries, held items, PC recovery, poison persistence after death, and the final rules for individual fainting. These omissions must become deliberate balancing choices. An item list alone does not implement the intended economy.

12.2 Seeking a companion

Confirmed emotional structure. The player searches the fog for an individual they knew. The Pokémon roam, can be fought, and require recapture. Odds are not generous. A very limited opportunity can end in permanent disappearance.

Prototype rule, not final balance. A whole-party loss in an integrated living-world battle triggers the astral sequence. An individual faint during a won battle does not currently impose permanent loss. Each spirit has

one encounter with a six-round deadline and an engine catch-rate parameter of 35. That parameter is not a 35% probability; several throws can occur within the encounter.

Prototype support. A borrowed Natu enables astral battles, supplies are granted once per journey, and a different fallback Natu permits continuation with no recovered companions. These are provisional solutions to playability, not settled lore. Avoid explaining every test accommodation as a cosmic law.

The recovered Pokémon must be the same individual in all meaningful respects: name, owner, form, moves, characteristics, held item, and history. A species replacement is not a reunion. Technical failures should not deliberately count as narrative failure.

12.3 Limited rest

Confirmed revision, implemented in 0.6.1. Each fire can heal the party once every 15 real minutes. The cooldown belongs to that particular fire and persists in saves; time away from the game counts.

Implementation choice: eligible rests restore full HP and PP, including fainted party members, but leave poison and other status conditions unchanged. Eggs and borrowed astral guides are excluded. Astral recapture and return retain their separate 25% HP floor.

Field resources, implemented in 0.6.1. Five berry trees supply HP-restoring Oran or Citrus Berries. Each gives two berries and regrows after one real hour; these quantities and regrowth timing are provisional balancing choices. Status-curing berries are not distributed. Tall grass supplements visible roaming Pokémon: Aipom, Weedle and regional Wurmple in the Listening Wood; Zigzagoon, Sunkern and Ekans on the South Coast Road. Ordinary paths remain free of random encounters. All these encounters use the existing astral-loss rules.

Presentation refinement. Small pale threshold stones mark map passage tiles. Selected windows and tended lanterns cast amber light while ordinary locations remain permanently night. This adds local warmth without changing the global night palette.

Design requirement. Scarcity must permit continued play. The route with lost companions and the no-Suicune ending must remain viable. Preserve the emotional pressure of recovery without accidentally making a mathematically impossible journey.

12.4 Permanence and saves

Confirmed intent. Failed recovery can have permanent consequences in the player's continuing story. **Open implementation.** The final save/reload policy is undecided. The prototype uses ordinary manual saves; loading an older save can reverse a loss. No ironman or anti-reload policy is approved.

Make the distinction between a normal battle faint, a death event, an unresolved spirit, and a permanent memorial understandable. Do not promise final rules that have not yet been designed.

12.5 The cemetery gallery and battle

Confirmed. A late magical cemetery contains a gallery of fallen Pokémon. If enough exist, the shrine leader uses exactly those Pokémon for his team. Otherwise he has an impressive team of his own.

Open selection detail. Whether a short memorial roster produces a mixed team or the master's full fallback team. The prototype helper fills vacancies with fallback Pokémon and selects up to six recent permanent

losses. That is a provisional implementation, not a fixed interpretation of every possible roster. More than six losses also require an approved selection rule.

The archive should preserve individuals, not only species silhouettes. Recognisable names and histories are central. The encounter must not mutate or overwrite their memorial records.

Design interpretation. The gallery acknowledges absence. The battle asks the player to face their relation to loss and control. It should not imply that every lost Pokémon suffered because the player was morally defective. A player who lost nobody still deserves a complete, meaningful shrine encounter. No minimum death quota is intended.

The trial does not automatically bring the lost back. Its relation to the Koga story is acceptance of an unresolved absence and recognition of what grief can tempt a person to do.

13. Endings and irreversible consequences

13.1 The shared commitment

Confirmed. The protagonist ultimately sides with people because living innocents suffer and human kinship remains stronger, even after the demons' case becomes persuasive. A fully developed demons-aligned alternate campaign is not established.

Victory must not falsify the ancient account or declare the victims' grievance illegitimate. The protagonist's decision is morally situated. They can protect present people and still acknowledge the debt those communities inherited.

13.2 The more hopeful route

Confirmed core. The player saves and heals Suicune into Water/Grass, obtains the mystic sabre, and gains the intended final use of Behemoth Blade. The result permits a better resolution than ordinary victory without him.

Proposed mechanism. The special strike breaks a continuing supernatural connection that defeating the boss's immediate manifestation cannot break. This can explain why a mechanically winnable fight still has different consequences. The exact connection, cost, and scene remain open.

Proposed aftermath. Signs of living water return, some routes become usable, and familiar survivors resume small activities. Keep improvement concrete and partial. Koga can remain missing, companions can remain dead, and history can remain painful within a hopeful ending.

13.3 The darker victory

Confirmed. Without Suicune, the game remains finishable. Winning the final fight does not make everything right. Some remaining harm lies beyond the player's power to fix.

Open. Which places remain damaged, whether the sea threat is contained or merely altered, the protagonist's final condition, and the fate of specific characters. Avoid fixing these through a casual descriptive flourish.

Proposed aftermath. The immediate attack stops, but certain waters or homes remain inaccessible, a haunting persists, or a necessary separation cannot be ended. Choose the final form of loss once the boss mechanism is settled. It must feel like a consequential outcome of the same world, not an unrelated punishment scene.

Do not add a secret grind, replacement legendary, generic Behemoth Blade user, or late item that silently recovers the identical hopeful outcome after the unique solution is gone.

13.4 Edge cases to settle before implementation

The final story logic must address Suicune captured but unhealed, healed but later lost, the sabre found without him, possession of the item without its intended use, and a player who never reached the refuge. These conditions are not all approved independent endings.

Proposed provisional rule. The hopeful resolution requires the actual recovered Suicune and the sabre's intended final interaction. Missing prerequisites preserve the winnable darker route. Confirm the precise rule before encoding permanent ending flags.

Neither ending should automatically resolve real Koga's disappearance or the sea's ultimate nature. The hopeful route offers meaningful repair, not universal restoration.

14. Revelation and continuity rules

14.1 What the player learns, and when

Proposed information order based on confirmed reveals.

At home, the player knows Mother's ordinary role, their companion, and the local sea. Early astral survival receives a provisional explanation based on luck. Lapras is first experienced as frightening.

The pie and necklace sequence establishes Mother's familiarity with the recipe, the seller's wife, modest coastal crime, the dock-city museum and the existence of a lighthouse vault. It reveals no ritual, curse, lower-lamp function, vault purpose, deep-sea mythology or sabre plan.

In the mountain and river communities, the player learns who Koga is, knows his team, sees poison's defensive use, and hears the mental-corruption rumour. The absence comes after genuine attachment.

During the false return, the protagonist believes they share something with Koga. The astral quest strengthens that belief. Discrepancies and cruelty then challenge it. Poisoning and the unfamiliar boss team add evidence.

After the imitation's destruction, the villagers' ritual establishes its origin. This revelation answers "What did we meet?" while leaving "Where is Koga?" unanswered.

Late submerged discoveries establish the ancient victims and human wrongdoing. Mother's role explains the protagonist's condition. The legendary story explains Lapras's magical link near the end. Their exact local order remains adjustable, but none should be fully disclosed in the opening.

14.2 Mysteries with different functions

Intentional unresolved mystery: real Koga's fate. Preserve it even in optional content and the best ending.

Intentional incompleteness: the sea's deepest nature. Concrete historical evidence and particular supernatural rules can still be knowable.

Reveal that must become clear: the poison imitation is not real Koga; the protagonist was an existing person altered by Mother's magic; the demons' grievance arises from actual human actions; Lapras carries the legendary's magic.

Authorial decisions still open: Mother's exact religious objective, Koga's mother's absence, exact ancient atrocity, the guardian's identity, the legendary's relation to the sea, and the final boss mechanism. These are not automatically permanent mysteries. They need deliberate decisions about what writers know and what players learn.

14.3 Continuity safeguards

- Do not return the protagonist to the small garden house from earlier concept art. The lighthouse is home.
- Do not introduce a conventional rival or professor to explain menus or quests.
- Do not reveal the eternal-child ritual or Mother's guilt in the opening; use restrained village foreshadowing.
- Do not populate the starting village with other young permanent human residents without an explicit change to its established age pattern.
- Do not retain the automatic starting Natu or the old quest order: Pookie's walk precedes the household choice; the missing-keys and oil errand follows it. Oil is obtained inside the unlocked shop. The pier incident during the walk is optional and shows no Lapras.
- The implemented household trio is Natu, Makuhita and Poochyena. Do not confuse earlier Meditite suggestions with its evolved form Medicham, or treat unbuilt third evolutions as completed content.
- Do not substitute a standard badge circuit for the shrine structure.
- Do not treat real Koga and pseudo-Koga as one person's corruption arc.
- Do not put any of real Koga's familiar team into the clone's boss roster without an explicit change to this central clue.
- Do not let a confirmed Koga soul appear in the cemetery or astral plane and thereby settle the disappearance.
- Do not confuse the protagonist's mother with Koga's mother or resolve either woman's open history by assumption.
- Do not interpret Poison's demonic defence as an unexplained global type-chart rule or proof that all Poison partners corrupt minds.
- Do not make ordinary Ghost Pokémon equivalent to water demons.
- Do not turn the preserved legendary ambiguity into a confirmed identity with the sea or final boss.
- Do not move the corrupted Suicune confrontation after the pseudo-Koga boss.

- Do not make the no-Suicune route unwinnable or give it an unapproved substitute hopeful solution.
- Do not make the cemetery a guaranteed resurrection service.
- Do not allow early dialogue, Pokédex text, loading tips, or item descriptions to reveal late truths prematurely.
- Do not treat working names, stock assets, levels, catch parameters, or debug conveniences as approved lore.
- Characters know particular things. The seller's domestic familiarity does not make him aware of pearl magic; an Abyss thief's dock contact does not grant knowledge of the sabre's final purpose.
- City 2's museum display and later theft are future canon, not permission to build the heist in the early necklace milestone.
- Keep the plate ordinary, the pearls a recurring category, and the seller's mourning healthy. Preserve the pleasurable meal.

15. Art, sound, dialogue, and quest design

15.1 Visual direction

Confirmed world rule: perpetual night. Ordinary locations always take place at night. Retain the grey, dark, desaturated mood of the earlier opening; the brighter, cheerful autumn treatment in 0.5 is superseded. Autumn appears through worn foliage, stone, shore texture and small flowers under moonlight. Use charcoal, slate, cold grey-blue water and restrained traces of colour. Small lamps and sheltered interiors may offer warmth without turning the landscape into daylight.

Daylight or unusually bright surroundings are reserved for specifically approved magical locations later in the game. Do not add a normal day/night cycle, sunrise, or host-clock-dependent brightening. This is a firm world and presentation rule. Its narrative cause has not been established; do not invent one or reveal a supposed explanation in early dialogue. Ordinary battle scenes and time-of-day queries should also use night.

Confirmed direction: familiarity before strangeness. The opening should feel almost like a vanilla Generation 3 Pokémon reskin. Preserve its tile scale, familiar silhouettes, readable paths, movement and ordinary dialogue presentation. The coastal palette is dark and desaturated: slate rock, grey-blue sea, muted foliage, weathered timber, dim flowers and small amber lamp accents. Comfy autumn JRPG pixel art meets the sorrow and unease of Dark Souls and Twin Peaks. These are tonal references, not a request to copy their assets.

Introduce deeper mechanical changes, unusual scripts, animation and stronger visual departures progressively through the journey. Let the player first grow attached to a recognisable world. Early effects should serve a specific scene: a dog reacts to nothing visible; a quiet camera movement reveals more sea; a pale presence slowly becomes perceptible. Avoid front-loading a catalogue of custom systems or constantly advertising how modified the game is. Existing recovery mechanics remain in the prototype; this rule governs presentation and future pacing, rather than removing established mechanics.

First coast, implemented in 0.5. An irregular rocky lighthouse islet connects to the village by a worn stone causeway. Boulder clusters enclose the headland; a sandy beach sits in the sheltered bay. Muted autumn trees, flowers sheltered by stones, scattered shore rocks, sea glass and tended lamps provide signs of continuing care. The long timber pier faces an expanse of water; the map edge must stay outside every reachable view, including the encounter camera. Pookie's first bark reveals nothing. The later Lapras glimpse uses a pause, quieted music, gentle camera travel and a gradual appearance and disappearance.

Later regional palettes remain proposals. Forest greens and pale refuge light; clean winter whites before purple and green contamination; desaturated astral fog with recognisable companion colours. Keep terrain and interactive objects legible.

The town's transformation should alter surfaces, water, movement, and residents' routines. It should not consist only of a purple overlay. Beauty needs its own visual treatment: a clear interval after rain, a living garden, a companion at rest, or light moving through water.

Asset status. Existing art is temporary Essentials material. The current Lapras apparition uses a pale stock icon. Earlier concept images establish atmosphere, not a finished tileset or approved sprite sheet. Record final palettes and designs separately when chosen.

15.2 Sound and music

Proposed direction. The sea should have an audible presence even when off screen. Distinguish exposed coast, sheltered home, winter courtyard, forest interior, and astral shore through sound density and distance. Silence and changes in familiar sound can carry horror more effectively than constant stingers.

Musical material can return altered across related places: Koga's living warmth, the false reunion, and the polluted settlement; the refuge before and after contamination; the domestic lighthouse and the late return. Do not make every variation announce a twist before the scene does.

Use rare, sustained beauty rather than continuous melancholy wallpaper. A hopeful scene may permit a fuller phrase or harmonic resolution that the region usually withholds. These are compositional proposals, not an approved soundtrack specification.

Prototype. Two original ambient loops accompany parts of the opening. They are a starting point, not the final regional score.

15.3 Dialogue

Confirmed. Sad dialogue, riddles, solitude, and meaningful help matter more than frequent trainer spectacle. Koga and the apprentices must retain a notably warm register.

Proposed writing rules. Let characters know particular things rather than speak for the entire world. Mix practical conversation with implication. Use silence only when a scene gives it meaning. Not everyone should speak in cryptic prophecy.

Koga's warmth should be direct; Mother's evasions selective; the sister's stories personal; the guardian's grief attached to a particular place. Criminals can sound impatient, transactional, or frightened instead of delivering theatrical claims about world domination.

A riddle should connect to an observable feature, custom, or earlier statement. Obscure lore should enrich an answer, not make essential progression depend on guessing the writer's private symbolism.

15.4 Small quests and useful failures

Proposed quest examples. Repair a lamp for a route that only one person still uses. Carry a message to a house whose resident has already left. Clear a dangerous path and find that its intended traveller cannot make the journey. Help restore a shared room after poisoning. These are examples of scale and tone, not new confirmed events.

Each quest should define what the player understands, what they can change, what remains beyond them, and how the outcome appears in the world. Failure can still produce knowledge, safety for someone else, or a truthful farewell. Avoid writing every quest as an inevitable failure disguised by meaningless choices.

15.5 Horror boundaries for this project

Design interpretation. Terror should emerge from behaviour, attachment, scale, and the corruption of familiar places. Pseudo-Koga's brutal act and disfigurement need force, but the game does not yet have an approved graphic-violence level. Do not introduce gratuitous gore as a substitute for the intended sadness and mystery.

Maintain readable scenes, restrained flashing, and clear battle feedback. Mystery about the sea's intentions is productive; uncertainty about whether the game registered a button press is not.

16. Open decisions and production record

16.1 Decisions needed before their relevant chapters

World: final title, regional name, map scale, exact geography, additional settlements, historical era, the ancient wrong, and the mechanism of the present breach.

People: protagonist design and chronological age, Mother's exact religious objective and fate, Koga's sister's name and arc, Koga's mother's absence, criminal leadership, guardian identity, and individual shrine masters. Real Koga's ultimate fate is intentionally withheld, not a required implementation answer.

Pokémon: regional dex size, final early companions, Lapras design and unsettling truth, Xatu's further evolution and item, both Koga team rosters, Suicune's healing process, the legendary, final bosses, and the sabre's rules.

Progression: shrine count, powers, incense acquisition and retries, Dive permission and fallback, criminal/Koga timeline, shared astral quest, and the precise sequence of late revelations.

Loss and endings: individual faint versus death, spirit opportunity and catch balance, status persistence, recovery resources, save/reload policy, cemetery roster selection, Suicune edge cases, and the specific unresolved damage of the darker ending.

Resolve these when useful to concrete work. There is no need to freeze every species, town, and dialogue before building the next coherent area.

16.2 What currently exists

Prototype 0.6.0. Nine playable opening maps: the keeper's house, Shiohama, an introductory Listening Wood area, the lantern room, Beyond the Shore, the oil shop, the child's bedroom, the south coast road and the old storehouse. The opening includes Mother's visit and family scene, Pookie's hundred-step walk and optional pier incident, household companion choice, recoverable shop keys, an indoor oil errand, tending the lamp, a later Lapras glimpse, limited rest, optional Natu and Frillish encounters, an astral companion-recovery loop, permanent-loss records within the saved timeline, a title scene, and two ambient loops. The oil-seller expansion adds pie and plate handoffs, a meal, robbery, southward pursuit, three small trainer battles, overheard criminal dialogue, necklace recovery and return, restrained wife revelation, a tiny pearl glint and a casual vault reference. Trainer defeats use the existing astral loop.

The user confirmed that the 0.4 native Mac build works. The 0.6.0 expansion still needs their on-device check. Koga's towns and arc, the complete forest, shrines, Dive progression, custom regional species, Suicune, the sabre, the final cemetery battle, water-demon bosses, and endings remain future development. Existing helper functions are not completed chapters.

16.3 Working arrangement as of 9 September 2026

The user reports that an app update stopped their local Codex/ChatGPT development app from running on the older Mac. The project will continue in this phone-accessed workspace, with a maintained downloadable project ZIP and separate game bible and developer guide.

The Mac remains the intended machine for testing and playing: Intel MacBook Pro, Mid-2015, macOS Monterey 12.7.5. A native Mac app is packaged with mkxp-z 2.4.2/826929e and Ruby 3.1. Its Intel code and bundled dependencies target macOS 10.13 or earlier. Actual engine rendering and save checks were run on Linux; the user confirmed that the 0.3 native Mac app works, then confirmed the 0.4 update works. The user confirmed 0.6.0 works. Version 0.6.1 needs their on-device check. The maintained project also retains its Windows launcher.

Future work should preserve four practical distinctions: the latest source package, this creative record, implementation instructions, and what has actually passed on-device testing. The current milestone adds the neighbour quest, while preserving the perpetual-night coast, earlier domestic opening and native Mac app. Future chapters remain separate milestones.

16.4 Maintenance and provenance

This bible consolidates the worldbuilding conversation and the earlier design record. New connective geography, historical possibilities, chapter divisions, quest examples, and presentation ideas are labelled as proposals. It does not use external Pokémon lore to settle this game's unresolved continuity.

For an accepted change, update the relevant passage and record the decision briefly. Keep proposals visibly provisional. Update the copy inside the project ZIP alongside the separate document so subsequent sessions do not inherit contradictory worlds.

Revision record: Version 1.1, 9 September 2026. Added Mother's belief and mixed ritual motive, eternal childhood, an elderly starting village, guilt-driven containment and age-driven release, late-reveal boundaries, oil-shop interior and post-lamp household companion choice. Added provisional starter options without locking the roster. These opening changes are documented, not yet implemented.

Version 1.0, 9 September 2026. Consolidated confirmed lore; expanded the regional, character, historical, quest, and ending outlines; added explicit mystery and continuity rules; separated prototype behaviour from intended mechanics; recorded the revised phone-workspace/Mac-playtest arrangement.

Revision record: Version 1.2, 9 September 2026. Recorded the implemented Natu/Makuhita/Poochyena household choice, oil-shop interior, lamp interaction, restrained elderly-villager dialogue, legacy-save behavior and native Mac packaging. Custom third evolutions remain unbuilt. The 1.1 revision note above is historical.

Revision record: Version 1.3, 9 September 2026. Recorded the bedroom and main-hall introduction, Makuhita's box work, Pookie's first walk and optional unseen pier presence, post-walk companion choice, forest Key Item and moving seller. This explicitly supersedes the earlier oil-before-choice order. Existing 0.2/0.3 journeys retain their progress; the new prologue is for new games.

Revision record: Version 1.4, 9 September 2026. Established the Gen 3 opening and gradual introduction of deeper systems as a general development rule. Recorded the autumn/noir coastal art direction, rocky lighthouse approach, beach and flowers, expanded sea and longer pier, and restrained encounter staging. The 0.5 coast is implemented; the later regional transformations remain planned.

Revision record: Version 1.5, 10 September 2026. Confirmed perpetual night for ordinary locations, with daylight reserved for future magical exceptions. Superseded the bright 0.5 autumn palette with a dark, desaturated moonlit coast and forest. Kept the expanded geography, details, Gen 3 familiarity and gradual revelations. The cause of perpetual night remains unspecified.

Revision record: Version 1.6, 10 September 2026. Added the confirmed pie/plate/robbery/pursuit/necklace quest and healthy-grief counterpoint; recorded ordinary blue-reed pottery, City 4 hometown food, Ellie as working name, the lighthouse vault seed and unusual pearls as a recurring category. Established Team Abyss as working name. Recorded City 2's dock/distribution identity, major museum, public sabre display, later Abyss theft with incomplete understanding, and the eventual Suicune/Behemoth Blade connection as future canon only. Final city maps/names, sabre provenance, heist staging and vault purpose remain open. Updated playable status to 0.6; no later city, museum, heist or final-resolution gameplay was built.

20. The vault and first museum visit - 0.7.0

Confirmed sequence; now implemented. After the necklace's return, the seller gives the protagonist a permanent Key Item: a Blue-Reed Keepsake, a small ceramic charm from his hometown. It is a personal thank-you. It is not a vault key, does not reveal magic, and has no implemented special use. Its eventual practical purpose remains open. Existing completed-necklace saves can collect it on the next shop visit.

The seller visibly walks towards the lighthouse to ask Mother to keep the necklace safe. In the main hall, Mother opens the locked stair door with her own key. The player follows the stairs down into a cellar containing ordinary oil supplies, crates and repaired maintenance tools. An unusually heavy iron door opens into a large stone vault with cabinets, locked drawers and mostly empty storage bays. Its scale exceeds the apparent needs of this household. Do not explain its origin or purpose yet.

Mother and the seller place the necklace safely inside. Their short conversation recommends seeing the sabre on display in the dock-city museum. Mother asks whether it is still exhibited; this does not establish that she knows its future purpose. The seller knows the way to the museum. Neither explains the later mythology or Suicune's connection. The scene preserves restrained humour and ordinary neighbourly trust.

Geography, confirmed. The dock city starts beside the young thieves' old storehouse. An eastward path connects the existing coast road directly to the first quay. Wet stone, warehouses, crates, lanterns and mooring piers introduce its trade identity. Only the outskirts, museum approach and first public exhibition hall are implemented. The final city name and complete plan remain open; “The Docks” and “Dockside Museum” are working labels.

The public exhibit, implemented. The unique mystic sabre rests behind glass. Its public label calls it a sabre, with an unknown maker and an incomplete account of its arrival. Other exhibits present ordinary coastal lives: a bell, sounding weights, a shipping ledger and ceramic fragments. The attendant distinguishes missing evidence from conjecture. Looking at the blade completes this visit; the player does not receive it. Mother and the seller return to their usual rooms afterwards.

Still reserved. No Team Abyss museum theft, full sabre provenance, magical combat use, Suicune chapter or ending has been implemented. The vault visit reveals no explanation of Mother's ritual, the lower lamp, eternal childhood or the sea entities.

20.1 The working waterfront - 0.7.1

Implemented environmental expansion. The first dock-city area now has paved streets and a museum forecourt, brick houses, waterfront workshops and lodging, a customs warehouse, lanterns, small moored boats, nets and a fish stall. Brief resident and worker dialogue concerns ordinary trade and keeping things repaired. New shop frontages are closed; their interiors are not part of this milestone. The existing museum remains visitable.

Keep the perpetual night and Gen 3 familiarity. Warm light belongs inside visible window panes and lanterns, preserving the dark streets and sea. These local additions establish a working settlement without fixing the city's final name or complete geography. No new magical explanation, criminal plan or late-game revelation is introduced.

Revision record: Version 1.9, 12 September 2026. Recorded dock street/building/quay expansion, correctly aligned window lighting and the 0.7.1 playable baseline. Fixed post-cutscene entrance collisions without changing quest requirements. Later sabre theft, Suicune and final-resolution content remain reserved.

21. Tidebound Sunkern - the absent sun

Confirmed; implemented in 0.7.2. Sunkern is not thriving in the region's perpetual night. Its faded ochre and olive shell, drooping sage leaves with dry tips, and tired, sad expression tell that story visually. Its regional typing is Grass/Dark. It remains a small, vulnerable seed Pokemon. Dark typing does not establish evil, demonic possession or moral corruption. The absence of sunlight itself is enough for this local story.

Playable placement. Newly encountered Sunkern in the southern road's tall grass use the regional form. Existing captured individuals keep their form and identity. Front and back battle sprites and the two-frame party icon show the same wilted design. Shiny individuals currently use that same palette; a distinct shiny appearance remains open.

Moves, implementation choices. Level 1 Absorb and Growth; 4 Payback; 7 Ingrain; 10 Mega Drain; 13 Leech Seed; 16 Assurance; 19 Worry Seed; 22 Giga Drain; 25 Endeavor; 28 Endure; 31 Dark Pulse; 34 Energy Ball; 37 Seed Bomb; 40 Grassy Terrain. The pattern favours drawing energy from the surroundings, anchoring itself and responding to danger. Sun-themed moves are removed from its regional level-up, tutor and egg lists. This is a modest early companion, with the original base stats retained at 30 each. Existing abilities remain unchanged. These values are adjustable game balance, not immutable lore.

Evolution updated in 0.7.3. Tidebound Sunkern now evolves into Moonkern, described below. This supersedes its provisional Sun Stone-to-Sunflora path. Ordinary Sunkern retains that original evolution. No sunlight location or cure quest is introduced.

Revision record: Version 1.10, 13 September 2026. Added the user-confirmed sun-deprived Grass/Dark Sunkern, its sad muted sprite direction, regional encounter implementation and provisional moveset. Preserved ordinary Sunkern, existing companions, all prior locations and late-game mysteries.

22. Moonkern - the bloom that never came

Confirmed concept; implemented in 0.7.3. Moonkern is the Grass/Ghost evolution of Tidebound Sunkern. The plant wanted to sprout, but no sun came. Its physical body never grew into the hoped-for plant. What remains is a spirit in the outline of a Sunkern: a hollow seed contour, spectral drooping leaves, and a face that combines sadness, exhaustion and restrained anger. The name Moonkern is the working species name.

The outline uses pale sage and moon-silver against dusty violet, with sparse wisps. Its body is transparent rather than a solid recolour. The front, back and party icon retain the same silhouette. The name does not establish a new lunar deity, moon ritual or connection to the final legendary. It expresses a small tragedy within the sunless world. Its Ghost typing does not settle the rules governing human ghosts, water demons or astral companions.

Playable evolution, provisional balance. Tidebound Sunkern evolves at level 14, following the 0.7.4 revision. No item, battle loss or companion sacrifice is required. Normal cancellation and Everstone rules apply. Existing regional Sunkern become eligible on a subsequent level gain; they are not silently

transformed on loading. Ordinary Sunkern still evolves into Sunflora with a Sun Stone. Moonkern now evolves into Moonflora at level 20.

Strength. Base HP 65, Attack 45, Defence 65, Special Attack 105, Special Defence 100, Speed 60; total 440. It becomes a capable special attacker with better endurance, retaining relatively low physical attack. Abilities: Insomnia or Infiltrator; hidden ability Cursed Body. These choices support the restless spectral form and remain adjustable balance decisions.

Moves. Hex on evolution. Level 1 Absorb, Growth, Astonish and Spite; 4 Payback; 7 Ingrain; 10 Mega Drain; 13 Leech Seed; 16 Confuse Ray; 19 Worry Seed; 22 Giga Drain; 25 Endure; 28 Will-O-Wisp; 31 Shadow Ball; 34 Energy Ball; 37 Strength Sap; 40 Grassy Terrain; 44 Leaf Storm. Evolving keeps the individual's current moves and offers Hex through the ordinary move-learning interface. The combination of Will-O-Wisp and Hex gives its resentment a clear battle expression.

Presentation status. Front and back sprites, party icon and species data are implemented. A separate shiny palette and original cry remain open; the current build uses the same palette for shiny individuals and temporarily reuses Sunkern's cry. No evolution quest or new map was added.

Revision record: Version 1.11, 13 September 2026. Added Moonkern's user-confirmed unfulfilled-growth concept, Grass/Ghost typing and spectral appearance. Implemented level-24 evolution, stronger stats and a revised moveset. Replaced the regional Sunflora placeholder while preserving ordinary Sunkern, existing companion identities and the game's loss rules.

23. Moonflora - the phantom flower

Confirmed; implemented in 0.7.4. Tidebound Sunkern evolves into Moonkern at level 14, and Moonkern into Moonflora at level 20. This replaces the earlier level-24 transition. Ordinary Sunkern still evolves into ordinary Sunflora with a Sun Stone.

Moonflora is Grass/Ghost: the spirit of the flower the seed wanted to become. Its round hollow face, simple ring of muted petals, short stem and leaf arms recall Sunflora. A tired, quietly angry expression carries its unresolved longing. This spectral flower does not establish that the physical plant finally grew or returned to life.

Art direction clarified by the user. The first Moonflora draft was too elaborate for the existing sprite style. The revised version uses compact stock-like proportions, fewer petal details, flat colours, a clear contour and no decorative wisps. Its hollow face provides the supernatural difference. Judge readability at actual game resolution alongside ordinary Pokemon. This supports the existing rule of familiarity before stronger stylistic departures.

Provisional balance. Base HP 75, Attack 50, Defence 80, Special Attack 115, Special Defence 110, Speed 60; total 490. Moonkern keeps its prior stats. Moonflora retains Insomnia/Infiltrator and hidden Cursed Body. It learns Shadow Ball on evolution; later Giga Drain at 22, Will-O-Wisp at 23, Endure at 25, Nasty Plot at 31, Energy Ball at 34, Strength Sap at 37, Grassy Terrain at 40 and Leaf Storm at 44. Earlier absorption and ghost moves remain available through its move list.

Evolving preserves the companion's identity and can be cancelled normally. Existing Pokemon already above the threshold qualify on their next level gain, one evolution stage per event. Moonflora has no further evolution. No new map, item or quest is required.

The front/back sprites and party icon are implemented. A distinct shiny palette and original cry remain open; the current build uses the same palette for shiny individuals and temporarily reuses Sunflora's cry.

Revision record: Version 1.12, 13 September 2026. Changed the regional evolution thresholds to 14 and 20, added Moonflora, and simplified its sprite to match the existing pixel-art style.

24. Tidebound Wurmple - pale-blue forest form

Confirmed; implemented in 0.7.5. The northern forest's Wurmple has bright, pale-blue colouring and Bug/Ice typing. Its familiar silhouette, poses and simple sprite shading remain intact. The user explicitly preferred a direct pixel-palette recolour to generating new artwork. Cream and yellow details remain; no crystals, aura, additional anatomy or effects were introduced.

New Wurmple encounters in the Listening Wood use this regional form. Existing owned Wurmple keep their original form. Encounter rates and levels are unchanged. Stats, abilities and moves remain inherited from Wurmple for this small update. A distinct shiny palette remains open; shiny regional sprites currently use the same pale-blue colours.

Evolutions reserved for later. No regional evolution design, name or typing has been established. The existing Silcoon/Cascoon routes remain playable as a provisional compatibility choice, yielding their ordinary forms. Do not treat this placeholder as the final design for the regional line. No explanation of the form's origin or new forest lore has been established.

Revision record: Version 1.13, 13 September 2026. Added the user-confirmed pale-blue Bug/Ice Wurmple and explicitly deferred its regional evolutions.

25. Wurmple's split - Glacivorm and the sleeping branch

Confirmed split; implemented in 0.7.6. This supersedes section 24's evolution deferral. Tidebound Wurmple has two distinct paths. At level 10 it evolves into Glacivorm or a Bug/Ice cocoon. The first branch is complete after that evolution. The cocoon will eventually evolve at level 55 into an Ice/Dragon pseudo-legendary. Its final name, appearance, stats, moves, abilities and story role remain reserved for later design.

The split uses Wurmple's original personality-value mechanism: approximately 50:50 across individuals, fixed when each individual is created. It is not a new random roll at each level or evolution attempt. Evolution cancellation, Everstone and saving preserve the same branch. Ordinary non-regional Wurmple retains its original level-7 Silcoon/Cascoon split.

25.1 Glaciverm

Glaciverm is an elongated, armoured ice-worm with a serpentine body. Its broad pale-blue shell plates overlap as it coils. A cream underside and short yellow forehead horn retain a visual connection with regional Wurmple. The 0.7.7 art revision adds Wurmple's rounded cream mouth and short lip crease as a further family resemblance. Small stern eyes, a clear silhouette and simple flat sprite shading suit the familiar opening style. It is an Ice/Bug insect, not the Ice/Dragon of the other branch. Its restrained field description places it beneath roots, using frozen chitin for protection while waiting to strike. No connection to the sea entities or new supernatural mythology has been established.

Confirmed core: level-10 evolution, Ice/Bug, base Attack 105, Defence 110, Speed 40, Technician, and access to Coil, Ice Shard, First Impression and Ice Fang. This fully evolved early branch exchanges speed and safe typing for immediate physical strength. Fire and Rock both deal 4x damage. The game's existing shrine structure remains; this design adds no gyms.

Implementation balance: HP 75, Attack 105, Defence 110, Special Attack 40, Special Defence 65, Speed 40; total 435. Technician is its sole ability, with no separate hidden ability. Growth remains Medium to avoid changing an individual's experience curve at evolution. Catch rate 75; base experience 145; defeating it yields 2 Defence EVs. Length 1.8 m, weight 24.0 kg. These supporting values and move levels are tuning choices, not fixed story facts.

It learns Bug Bite on evolution and Ice Shard at level 10. Its later moves include Bind at 13, Ice Fang at 16, First Impression at 20, Coil at 24, Pin Missile at 28, Iron Defence at 32, Icicle Spear at 36, X-Scissor at 40, Icicle Crash at 44 and Lunge at 48. Tackle, String Shot and Powder Snow are level-1 moves. Delaying Coil avoids giving its full setup combination immediately at level 10. The later multi-hit moves offer continued Technician utility without removing its typing weaknesses. It receives no added self-healing move.

Rules clarification: standard Technician gives 1.5x power to qualifying moves of power 60 or below. It boosts Bug Bite (60) and Ice Shard (40), but not Ice Fang (65) or First Impression (90). Their normal power is unchanged. Ice Shard has +1 priority; First Impression has +2 and works only on the first turn after entering battle. Coil raises Attack, Defence and Accuracy by one stage.

The new front/back sprites and two-frame party icon are implemented. Separate shiny colours and an original cry remain open; shiny currently shares the normal palette and the cry provisionally reuses Wurmple's. This is a complete playable evolution, not evidence that campaign-wide balance has been tested.

25.2 The cocoon branch

Historical scaffold (0.7.6; replaced by section 27 in 0.7.10): the other half of regional Wurmple evolves at level 10 into Frostcoo, a working name. It is Bug/Ice and provisionally reuses Silcoon's white cocoon sprites, base stats, Shed Skin ability and cry. It learns Harden on evolution, Powder Snow at 10 and Bug Bite at 15, retaining the individual's existing moves. This gives the second branch a valid, saveable Pokemon while its design is unfinished. Its placeholder art is not a final regional design.

Previously reserved; now implemented in section 28: the cocoon's level-55 evolution is an Ice/Dragon with a 600 stat total. It is now Nivalora, detailed in section 28. The earlier Glaciverm milestone left this branch open; 0.7.12 completes it.

26. Ghostly Lapras visual form - 0.7.8

Confirmed direction. Edit the original sprites manually so Lapras remains immediately recognisable among the stock Pokemon. White, ghostly colouring, a little mist and a distinctive head mark should suggest unease without making it incapable of the tenderness required by its later story.

Implemented visual draft. Cold-white and cream body, muted grey shell, jade-green eye and a short faded-yellow forehead scar. The mark and eye are small pixel accents. Sparse stepped mist sits behind the body; no elaborate aura or smooth painted effect. Front, rear and two-frame icon artwork retain stock proportions and poses. Shiny uses the same palette for now.

Playable scope. The established Water/Ghost regional typing now has a separate form definition. The existing later pier apparition uses this form, with its familiar fades and camera staging. Pookie's first bark still reveals nothing. Ordinary Lapras remains Water/Ice; no owned Pokemon is rewritten. Stats, abilities, moves and cry currently inherit original Lapras. This update adds no capture route, encounter table, quest or automatic companion.

Still open or future. Meaning of the forehead mark, recruitment, repeated acts that establish attachment, the unsettling revelation and the late link to the Water/Ghost legendary. This visual draft does not settle any of those mysteries or imply that Ghost typing makes Lapras malevolent.

27. Frostcoon: the frozen-silk cocoon - 0.7.11

Implemented design. Frostcoon is the Bug/Ice cocoon on the second regional Wurmple branch. It evolves at level 10 through the existing fixed personality split. The user requested its full stats, moveset, dex entry and manually edited sprites. The 0.7.11 support moveset supersedes its initial attacking design. The level-55 Ice/Dragon evolution is now implemented in section 28.

Role and tuning. HP 65, Attack 35, Defence 95, Special Attack 55, Special Defence 85, Speed 15; total 350. It trades Glacivorm's immediate physical offence for patience and dedicated support. Shell Armor prevents critical hits; it does not remove Fire/Rock weaknesses or cure status. Both Fire and Rock still deal 4x damage. These values are implementation balance choices, not evidence of campaign-wide testing. There is no hidden ability for now.

Moves. Spikes on evolution; Harden and String Shot at level 1; Wish at 10; Stun Spore at 13; Rain Dance at 16; Protect at 19; Life Dew at 22; Sticky Web at 25; Sleep Powder at 28; Hail at 31; Aurora Veil at 34; Reflect at 38; Light Screen at 42; Safeguard at 46; Baton Pass at 50; Wide Guard at 54. All granted moves are status category. Machine/tutor compatibility is in the maintained species sheet.

Support rules. Wish can heal a teammate switched into Frostcoon's position. Life Dew heals the user and active allies, not the bench. Neither cures poison or revives the fallen. Hail enables Aurora Veil; rain reduces Fire damage. Sleep and paralysis use ordinary accuracy, immunities and mutually exclusive major status rules. Hazards and Hail still cause native indirect damage. These battle tools do not add ordinary Pokemon Centre healing or field status cures.

Dex entry. It seals itself in silk glazed with frost. Even when its shell lies perfectly still, a faint scratching can be heard from within.

Appearance. The familiar Silcoon silhouette becomes pale blue frozen silk, with cold white highlights, blue shading and a small golden eye. Front, rear and two-frame icon sprites use direct palette edits; no image generation, elaborate crystals, aura or new anatomy. Shiny uses the same palette provisionally. The cry still reuses Silcoon's. No new connection to the sea entities is established.

Supporting data. Category Frozen Silk; height 0.7 m; weight 12.0 kg; catch rate 120; base experience 95; two Defence EVs; Medium growth; equal gender ratio; Bug egg group. Growth remains compatible with already saved individuals. Existing Frostcoon keep identity, current HP, status and selected support moves. Old attacks are replaced with support moves, retaining at most their remaining PP. Wurmple also loses inherited attacks on evolution. Provisional stats and former Shed Skin still refresh on load. Fainted companions remain fainted.

Updated in 0.7.12. The level-55 Ice/Dragon evolution is now implemented as Nivalora; see section 28. No campaign location or additional quest is added.

28. Nivalora: the kindly butterfly dragon - 0.7.12

Confirmed character. A rare, beautiful, kind-hearted and powerful benevolent creature: an Ice/Dragon butterfly dragon with Wurmple's recognizable face. It uses sleep rather than poison to quiet danger. This does not establish new sea mythology, a quest, a legendary status, or a cure for the world's curse. Nivalora is its implementation working name; the creative director may rename it.

Evolution and tuning. Frostcoon evolves at level 55. HP 100, Attack 45, Defence 65, Special Attack 130, Special Defence 115, Speed 145; total 600. Its very high Speed and strong special offence contrast with low physical Attack and modest Defence. Shield Dust protects against additional effects of damaging attacks, not direct status moves. Its existing line retains Medium growth, preserving current progression and saved levels. The 600 total fulfills the requested pseudo-legendary power level; full-campaign balance remains open.

Moves and disposition. Dragon Breath on evolution and Ice Beam at 55; Dragon Dance at 58, Roost at 61, Dragon Pulse at 64, Blizzard at 68, Quiver Dance at 72, Tailwind at 76 and Mist at 80. It retains its cocoon's support options, including Wish, Life Dew and Sleep Powder. The maintained species sheet gives the complete schedule. It has no poisoning moves in its own compatibility. Ordinary Dragon Breath paralysis and Ice-move freezing effects remain.

Healing. Wish can heal a switched-in companion; Life Dew heals active allies; Roost heals the user. None cures poison or resurrects a lost companion. Dragon Dance deliberately remains its standard Attack/Speed boost; Quiver Dance later supports special offence. These are battle abilities, not new field recovery.

Dex entry. Rarely seen, it shelters lost travelers beneath its frost-white wings. Its gentle scales lull frightened creatures to sleep, and it waits beside them until they wake.

Appearance and implementation. The approved white/pale-blue butterfly wings, golden eyes, cream split muzzle, head horn and curled tail remain. In the rear view the right upper wing tilts outward to separate the visible face from the wing edge. Front, rear and party sprites are active. Shiny currently shares the normal palette; Articuno's cry is a declared placeholder. No extra encounter is added: raising the established cocoon branch is the playable acquisition route. Narrative rarity does not alter Wurmple's existing fixed personality split.

Supporting data. Height 2.4 m; weight 22 kg; catch rate 45; base experience 300; three Speed EVs; Bug/Dragon egg groups; equal sex ratio; no hidden ability. No future evolution, new location or special recruitment story is implied.

0.7.17 canon addition: Natu's bedroom maze

Confirmed, 17 September 2026. The opening hide-and-seek game takes place inside a giant, maze-like bedroom. It is a psychic projection created by the household Natu. That explanation belongs to a later revelation. Natu remains the same familiar individual available at companion selection; solving the maze does not grant, replace or choose a starter.

Confirmed sequence. The protagonist navigates classic Pokémon-style pushers and teleporters to find Natu. Mother calls at the end. The next view of the bedroom shows its normal small interior. This happens once, only at the beginning. Later bedroom visits remain ordinary. It supersedes the former new-game button-guessing scene and Mother's physical bedroom entrance. Her main-hall conversation, Maku's boxes, Pookie's walk and all following quests retain their order.

Prototype 0.7.17. Start small for iteration: three compact sections, arrow tiles, diamond stopping tiles, paired teleport patches and one return-to-start misdirection. Familiar furniture and wood frame the puzzle. No encounters, combat, item cost, death or permanent failure. Saving inside the maze works. Existing journeys skip the new introduction. The opening presents only a familiar game of finding Wick.

Open. The final maze's size and refinements, and the later scene explaining Natu's projection. Do not connect it to Mother's ritual, the sea, the astral plane or a new power system without a further creative decision. This is an explicitly approved early magical element within the established Gen 3 style and familiarity-before-strangeness rule. It is not a daylight exception.

0.7.18 canon addition: the room before the room

Historical prototype, revised below in 0.7.19. The computer and direct Wick-to-maze transfer described here are superseded by books and the second false bedroom.

Confirmed opening. Before the psychic maze, a new journey starts in a small bedroom that initially resembles an ordinary Gen 3 room. Trying to leave returns the protagonist to its centre. The bed, computer, chair, books, clock, window, lamp, plant and rug all yield strange, dreamlike observations. The computer contains three messages that were never sent. Nothing here explains Mother's ritual, the water curse, the vault or the sea entities.

Implemented puzzle. At the bed, answer three questions correctly in succession. The unopened door is the colour Thursday; the empty chair was here before you; the sea sleeps under the pillow. Computer messages contain the answers, supported by the chair and colour-book descriptions. Wrong answers or abandoning an unfinished run reset it. A completed run stays solved, allowing repeated sleep choices without repeating all three questions.

Sleep choices. Five seconds, five minutes, five hours, five days, five months, five years, or twelve years; the player may also stay awake. Short sleeps return to the same room. Only choosing twelve years makes Wick materialize after waking. Speaking to him leads into the existing one-time maze. He is the same household Natu, not another creature or a chosen starter. There is no combat, penalty, inventory cost or real-time wait.

Continuity. The false room and maze are new-game-only experiences. After the maze, Mother calls, the ordinary bedroom remains, and the established household opening continues. Existing journeys retain their progress. Saving before or after Wick's appearance retains that state.

Meaning deliberately open. The twelve-year label does not confirm that twelve calendar years pass. The false room's origin and the meaning of its questions remain unresolved. Natu's established responsibility for the later maze is unchanged; do not automatically extend that explanation to this preceding room, or use it to disclose Mother's late lore. Exact wording and the small room layout are implemented choices open to refinement.

0.7.19: books, the water-curse leaf and the second bedroom

Confirmed setting. Tidebound takes place in a world that evokes the past. Do not place advanced electronic technology in its ordinary environments. Books, domestic craft, runes and magic belong here. Keep the premise implicit in the environment, rather than explaining the absence of computers through dialogue. Steampunk motifs are a possible later direction, not a requirement or an established technology system. No exact date or real-world historical period is fixed.

First room, revised. A book cupboard replaces the computer. Three little books preserve the door, chair and sea clues without electronic wording. The player occupies the bed while answering its questions and choosing sleep duration; cancellation or waking returns them beside it. Taking the stairs draws a circle of faint marks around the protagonist, who turns and fades before re-forming at the centre. The original three-answer puzzle and twelve-year sleep remain. Wick still appears, but now leads into the second false bedroom.

Optional forbidden reading. Behind a backwards book on the other shelf lies a stitched leaf titled Water curse. Choosing to read it opens four pages of long, fractured writing, displaced lines and words that spill beyond an ordinary message box. The reader may turn pages or close it. This text is unstable dream imagery, not an authoritative account of the curse. It reveals no facts about Mother's ritual, the protagonist's origin, the vault or the demons. Reading it is optional and does not gate either puzzle.

Second room. This larger version repeats and distorts the bedroom's furniture, planks and windows. A violet-grey palette with cold green traces distinguishes it. Repeated bookcases form a winding route to the distant bed; a second empty bed is a decoy furnishing. Four short readings along the route supply the associations needed by the four riddles. The language is darker and less coherent, but the puzzle remains solvable from the room itself.

Implemented riddle associations. The tooth beneath the floor keeps the house standing. A widow subtracting her name leaves a mouthful of snow. The count of an empty cradle's burials is Before. The last page is knocked upon by Nobody, wearing your voice. These are dream associations, not new biographical

facts. Four consecutive correct answers finish this room. Any wrong answer, or abandoning the question sequence, resets all four and returns the protagonist to this room's beginning. It does not replay the first bedroom, consume items or harm Pokemon.

Continuity. Success leads into the established directional-pusher and teleporter maze with Natu. Mother then calls and the normal small bedroom remains. The new sequence never reopens for a journey that already passed it. An unfinished older first-room save continues through the revised books and new second room; a save already in the established maze stays there. Saving within the second bedroom preserves the phase and position. The dream's origin and whether twelve years have any literal temporal meaning remain open.

0.7.20: a bird wants to play

Confirmed opening. Before either false bedroom, a Natu sleeps against a dark background. One eye opens, followed by the words: A bird wants to play. The player then directly guides the bird through a small, minimalist spirit maze towards the protagonist asleep in bed. Reaching the child leads directly into the existing first bedroom and its line, A room. Your room, probably.

Implemented presentation. One screen; near-black surroundings, faint slate paths, slowly drifting soft mist, a subdued bird and a distant bed. A few blind branches allow quiet exploration. There are no enemies, items, timers, battles or failure penalties. Movement uses the normal directional controls. The bird's initial breathing, opening eye, slow caption, trailing motion and final bedside pause carry the scene. The existing original ambient music plays more quietly and at a lower pitch during this prelude.

Scope and meaning. This is a brief playable prelude, not a new region or a second Pokemon companion. It precedes the book-cupboard bedroom, the larger four-riddle room and the established Natu maze. Do not equate its dream space with the later playable astral realm or explain Mother's ritual through it. Natu's actions suggest a connection; the precise metaphysics remain unspoken.

Prototype continuity. The prelude plays only on New Game. Continue never replays it. The single-screen scene has no save/menu interaction; saving resumes normally in the first bedroom. Completing it initializes the existing opening exactly once, retaining the 99 testing Rare Candies and the three household individuals.

29. Tidebound Psyduck and Whyduck - 0.7.22

Confirmed regional species. Shore Psyduck retains its familiar shape and its original moves and statistics. Its Tidebound form is Water/Psychic and evolves at level 16 into Whyduck. Ordinary Psyduck and Golduck still exist elsewhere; already owned ordinary Psyduck remain ordinary. The present demo offers a rare shore Psyduck encounter in the southern road grass and a visible level-8 Psyduck beside the road. Its precise place in the finished regional ecology remains open.

Whyduck retains Psyduck's rounded duck body, beak, feet and tail, with a calm penguin-like bearing. Its arms have left its aching head and angle outward as it prepares an incantation. The skull has visibly opened: uneven bone edges and a dark cleft surround a broad exposed, pink brain. Two irregular hemispheres are connected by winding folds and short roots that grow into the opening. It should read as brain tissue, never as a flower, hat or almond. The brain looks almost like something that has hatched, but whether it has a separate mind and whether it relates to Natu's projection or sea magic remain **unresolved**. Do not decide its origin without a new creative choice.

Battle character. Water/Psychic, base statistics HP 75, Attack 55, Defense 70, Special Attack 130, Special Defense 115, Speed 75 (total 520). It is a strong special attacker with substantial special resilience and a comparatively frail physical side. Own Tempo and Cloud Nine are its ordinary abilities; Inner Focus is its hidden ability. Psychic becomes available on evolution; later it learns Calm Mind, Psyshock, Future Sight and other psychic techniques along with aquatic moves. This is a deliberate prototype balance, adjustable after playtesting.

Pokédex entry. Its headaches ceased when the folds on its head opened. It stands quietly by the tide for hours, as if considering a question it cannot ask.

Visual continuity (approved for 0.7.24). Gen 3 pixel sprites reuse original Psyduck eye, hand and bill pixels, shifting the pupils down-left toward its opponent. Its brain is pink in the ordinary sprite and green in the ice-blue shiny. An uneven casting pose reverses its raised arm in the rear view; both icon frames share its palette. Regional Psyduck still looks like ordinary Psyduck. Whyduck's cry currently reuses Psyduck's as a placeholder; the final cry remains open.

30. Demo 1: the working harbour and the next crossing

Confirmed opening wording. After “A bird wants to play...” the opening instructs “Take it for a little walk, 100 steps.” This is dreamlike text, not a new counted objective. The existing Natu-to-bed spirit-maze gameplay remains unchanged.

Confirmed narrative vocabulary. A Pokémon that loses its HP is described as having died, rather than fainted. The demo changes the battle and field-poison messages; it does not introduce a different death/recovery system or claim that every stock interface has been rewritten.

First settlement. Shiohama's houses are old dark wood, with restrained stone foundations and sheltered warm windows. The lighthouse retains its existing exterior and garden. Ordinary locations remain perpetually night.

Implemented harbour. Two wooden sailing ships and their working crews now occupy the dock frontage. The Salt Thread carries mundane coastal cargo. The Little Promise is preparing to carry supplies and a passenger toward Psyduck Island. Both ship names and individual sailor names are implementation choices, not fixed regional history. Crews speak about moorings, flour, lamp oil, letters, sea watches, the museum's ordinary collections, trade with mountain settlements and pie from City 4. Their knowledge is local and partial. There is no early explanation of the water entities or the sabre's final purpose. A small harbour memorial honours absence without identifying specific historical deaths.

Optional battles. Sailors Nell and Oren can be challenged voluntarily; these are not progression gates. They use the existing battle/death framework. Their modest teams and precise levels remain balance choices.

Confirmed next destination. Psyduck Island is the intended next playable destination after the dock city. An eastern-pier captain offers passage. Accepting the invitation marks the end of Demo 1 and lets the player continue exploring the current region. No voyage or island map is implemented. The island's geography, inhabitants, story, exact place in the regional numbering and final name remain open. Do not turn a sailor's casual observation about its ducks into authoritative supernatural lore.

Ecology adjustment. The South Coast Road has a visible Tidebound Psyduck in addition to its grass encounters. Its evolution into Whyduck is now level 16, superseding level 33 for the regional form only. The approved appearance, stats and moves remain unchanged.